Grade 3 practice paper

Time allowed: 1½ hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
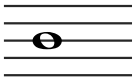
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks
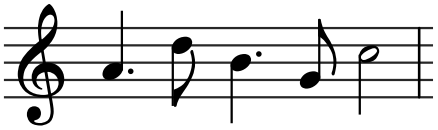
1. How many quavers make one semibreve?



A. 10 B. 8 C. 7 D. 16

3 marks

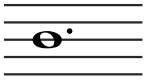
2. Which time signature fits this bar?



A. 3/8 B. 3/2 C. 2/4 D. 6/6

3 marks
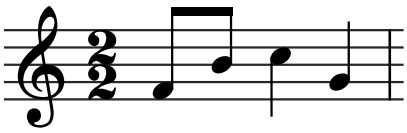
3. How many crotchets make one dotted semibreve?

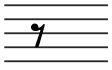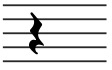


A. 12 B. 8 C. 5 D. 6

3 marks
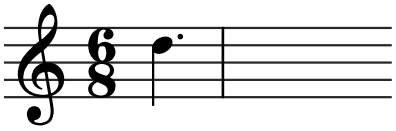
4. Which rest finishes this bar?



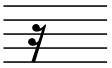
A.  B.  C.  D. 

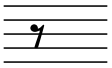
3 marks
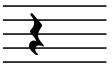
5. Which rest finishes this bar?



A. 

B. 
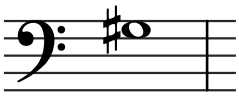
C. 

D. 

Section 2: Pitch **(15 marks)**

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Bass clef)

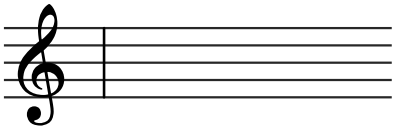


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

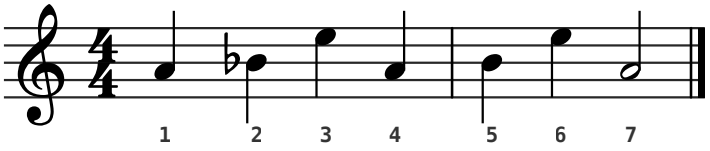
7. Write E on the stave. (Treble clef · any octave)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

8. What is note 5? (Treble clef)
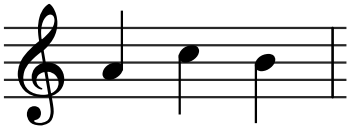


A. B

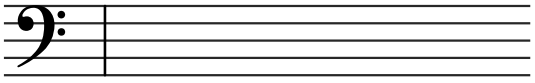
B. B♭

3 marks

9. Write this tune one octave lower in bass clef. (Given in treble clef)

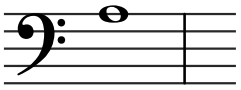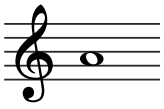


Write your answer on this stave:
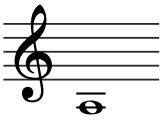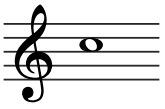


3 marks
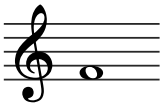
10. Which is this note one octave higher, written in treble clef? (Bass clef)



A. 

B. 
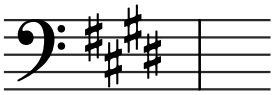
C. 

D. 

Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks

11. Which major key has this key signature? (Bass clef)



A. C major B. A major C. E major D. B♭ major

2 marks
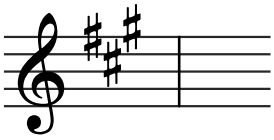
12. Is this a tone or a semitone? (C♭ to D♭)



A. Tone B. Semitone

2 marks

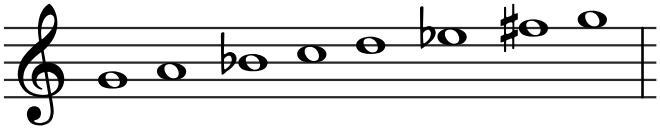
13. Which major key has this key signature? (Treble clef)



A. A major B. F major C. E major D. A♭ major

2 marks
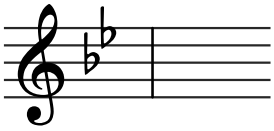
14. Which scale is this?



A. B harmonic minor B. G melodic minor C. G major D. G harmonic minor

2 marks

15. Which major key has this key signature? (Treble clef)

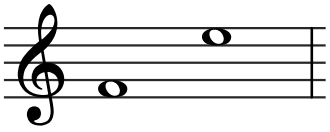


A. E major B. B♭ major C. G major D. D major

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (F up to E)



A. major 6th B. minor 7th C. major 7th D. perfect octave

2 marks

17. Which note is a major 2nd above A♭?

A. B𝄫 B. B♭ C. A♭ D. C♭
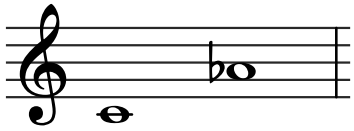
2 marks

18. Which note is a minor 3rd above E?

A. A B. G♭ C. G D. F

2 marks

19. Name this interval. (C up to A♭)



A. minor 6th B. minor 7th C. perfect 5th D. major 6th

2 marks

20. Which note is a perfect octave above A?

A. A B. B C. A♯ D. A♭

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks

21. What is the relative minor?

F major

A. C♯ minor B. B minor C. D minor D. C minor

2 marks

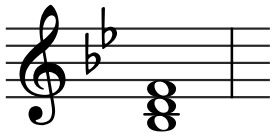
22. What is the relative minor?

G major

A. E minor B. D minor C. F♯ minor D. G minor

2 marks

23. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. A major B. B♭ major C. F major D. B♭ minor

2 marks

24. Spell the tonic triad of F minor.

A. F–A♭–C B. A–C–E C. C♯–E–G♯ D. D–F–A

2 marks

25. What is the relative minor?

A♭ major

A. E minor B. G minor C. F minor D. C♯ minor

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "held"?

Find the term

A. tenuto B. tempo primo C. molto D. lento

1 mark

27. What does this mean?

tenuto

A. held B. sweetly C. but D. as fast as possible

1 mark

28. Which is louder: f or pp?

f or pp

A. pp B. f

1 mark
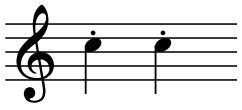
29. What does this mean?
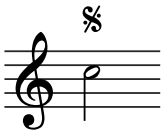
sempre

A. with B. boldly C. always D. heavily
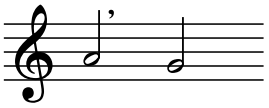
1 mark

30. Which picture shows a segno (the sign)?

A. 

B. 
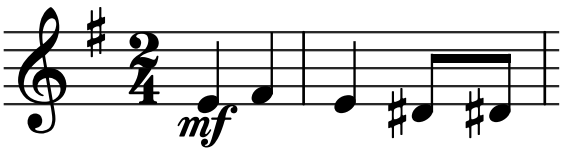
C. 
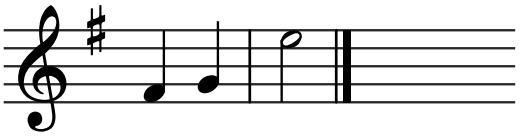
D. 

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Andante





2 marks

31. Which key is this melody in?

A. E minor B. A major C. E major D. D major
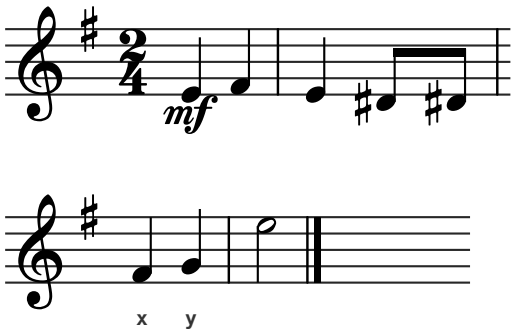
2 marks

32. How many beats are in each bar, and what is the beat?

A. 3 quavers B. 4 crotchets C. 2 crotchets D. 3 crotchets

2 marks

33. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. diminished 2nd B. major 3rd C. minor 2nd D. major 2nd

2 marks

34. Which is the highest note in the melody?

A. G B. F♯ C. E D. D♯

2 marks

35. What does "Andante" mean?

A. detached B. at a walking pace C. moderately loud D. more

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **B: 8**. A semibreve lasts 4 crotchet beats. A quaver lasts ½. 4 ÷ ½ = 8.
2. S1 · 3m **B: 3/2**. The notes add up to 3 minim beats, so 3/2 fits.
3. S1 · 3m **D: 6**. A dotted semibreve lasts 6 crotchet beats. A crotchet lasts 1. 6 ÷ 1 = 6.
4. S1 · 3m **D: crotchet rest**. A bar of 2/2 holds 2 minim beats. The notes leave a gap of one crotchet, so a crotchet rest finishes it.
5. S1 · 3m **D: dotted crotchet rest**. A bar of 6/8 holds 2 dotted crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one dotted crotchet, so a dotted crotchet rest finishes it.
6. S2 · 3m **G♯**. G♯. Landmark: F, the line between the bass clef's two dots. This note is 1 step above it: F, G. The sharp makes it G♯.
7. S2 · 3m **E**. E can go in more than one octave; any E was fine.
8. S2 · 3m **A: B**. The flat on note 2 only lasts until the bar line. Note 5 is in a new bar, so it's back to plain B.
9. S2 · 3m **A, C, B (bass clef)**. The notes are A, C, B, each moved down an octave.
10. S2 · 3m **A: treble clef note A4**. Same letter, A, but 7 steps higher. The trap is the one at the same pitch.
11. S3 · 2m **C: E major**. The last sharp is D♯. One step up from it is E, so E major.
12. S3 · 2m **A: Tone**. C♭ to D♭ is 2 semitones, so it's a tone.
13. S3 · 2m **A: A major**. The last sharp is G♯. One step up from it is A, so A major.
14. S3 · 2m **D: G harmonic minor**. It starts and ends on G. Only the 7th is raised, so it's harmonic minor.
15. S3 · 2m **B: B♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is B♭, so B♭ major.
16. S4 · 2m **C: major 7th**. Count the letters F G A B C D E: that's a 7th. 11 semitones, so it's a major 7th.
17. S4 · 2m **B: B♭**. Count 2 letters up from A♭ to get B. A major 2nd is 2 semitones, so it's B♭.
18. S4 · 2m **C: G**. Count 3 letters up from E to get G. A minor 3rd is 3 semitones, so it's G.
19. S4 · 2m **A: minor 6th**. Count the letters C D E F G A: that's a 6th. 8 semitones, so it's a minor 6th.
20. S4 · 2m **A: A**. Count 8 letters up from A to get A. A perfect octave is 12 semitones, so it's A.
21. S5 · 2m **C: D minor**. Count up to note 6 of F major: D. Both keys share the same key signature.
22. S5 · 2m **A: E minor**. Count up to note 6 of G major: E. Both keys share the same key signature.
23. S5 · 2m **B: B♭ major**. The bottom note is the tonic, B♭. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of B♭ major.
24. S5 · 2m **A: F–A♭–C**. Notes 1, 3 and 5 of F minor: F–A♭–C.
25. S5 · 2m **C: F minor**. Count up to note 6 of A♭ major: F. Both keys share the same key signature.
26. S6 · 1m **A: tenuto**. tenuto is Italian for "held".
27. S6 · 1m **A: held**. tenuto is Italian for "held".
28. S6 · 1m **B: f**. f means loud and pp means very quiet, so f is louder.
29. S6 · 1m **C: always**. sempre is Italian for "always".
30. S6 · 1m **B: segno (the sign)**. Segno (the sign) means the place D.S. sends you back to.
31. S7 · 2m **A: E minor**. The key signature has 1 sharp, the raised 7th (D♯) shows it's minor, and the melody ends on E: E minor.
32. S7 · 2m **C: 2 crotchets**. 2/4 has 2 crotchet beats in each bar.

33. S7 · 2m **C: minor 2nd**. The notes are F♯ and G: a minor 2nd.
34. S7 · 2m **C: E**. The highest note is E, in bar 4.
35. S7 · 2m **B: at a walking pace**. Andante means at a walking pace.

Grade 3 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 1½ hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
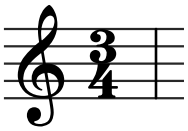
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks

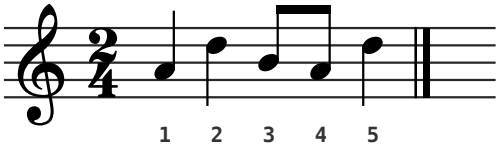
1. How many beats in a bar, and what is the beat?



A. 3 quavers B. 3 dotted quavers C. 3 minims D. 3 crotchets

3 marks

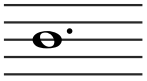
2. The first bar line is missing. Where does it go?



A. After note 2 B. After note 1 C. After note 4 D. After note 3

3 marks

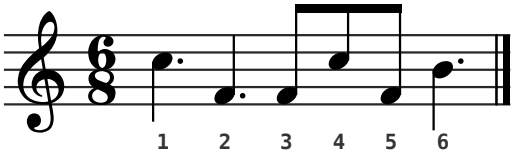
3. How many semiquavers make one dotted semibreve?



A. 24 B. 26 C. 25 D. 12

3 marks
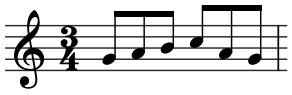
4. The first bar line is missing. Where does it go?
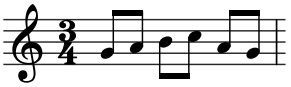


A. After note 1 B. After note 4 C. After note 2 D. After note 3

3 marks

5. Which bar is grouped correctly for 3/4?
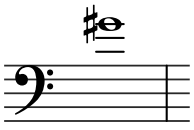
A. 

B. 

Section 2: Pitch **(15 marks)**

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Bass clef)
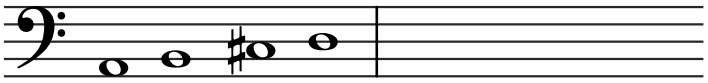


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

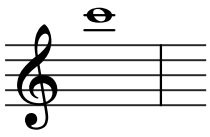
7. Here is the start of A major, going up. Write the next note. (Bass clef · no key signature, so use an accidental if it needs one)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

8. Name this note. (Treble clef)

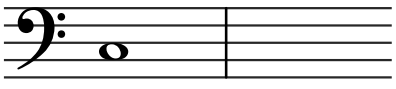


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

9. Write this note one octave lower. (Bass clef)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

10. Is this note above, below or at middle C? (Bass clef)

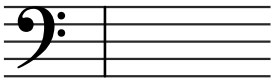


A. Above middle C B. Below middle C C. It is middle C

Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks

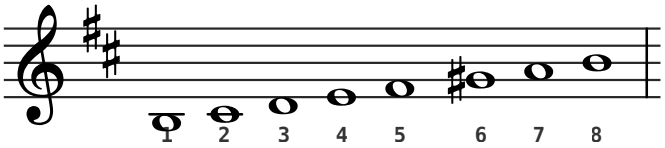
11. Which minor key has this key signature? (Bass clef)



A. D minor B. A minor C. E minor D. F♯ minor

2 marks
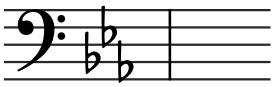
12. One note in this B melodic minor scale is wrong. Which number is it? (Going up)



Write your answer: _____

2 marks

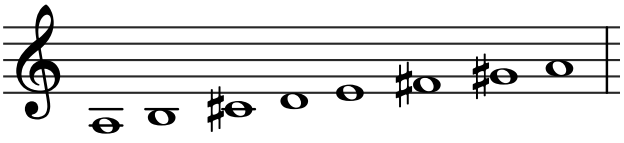
13. Which major key has this key signature? (Bass clef)



A. C major B. E♭ major C. B♭ major D. F major

2 marks

14. Which scale is this?



A. F♯ harmonic minor B. A major C. F major D. A harmonic minor

2 marks

15. Which flats are in A♭ major, in order?

A. F♭ C♭ G♭ D♭ B. B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭ G♭ C. B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭ D. D♭ A♭ E♭ B♭

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Which note is a minor 3rd above G?

A. B𝄫 B. B C. B♭ D. C♭

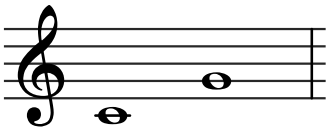
2 marks

17. Which note is a minor 7th above E♭?

A. D𝄫 B. E♭ C. D♭ D. C♭

2 marks

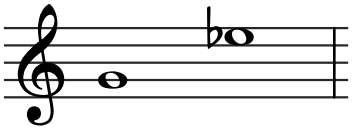
18. Name this interval. (C up to G)



A. perfect 5th B. major 6th C. perfect 4th

2 marks

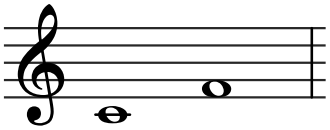
19. Name this interval. (G up to E♭)



A. perfect 5th B. minor 7th C. minor 6th D. major 6th

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (C up to F)

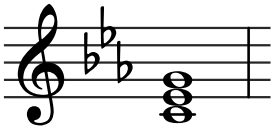


A. perfect 5th B. major 3rd C. perfect 4th

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks

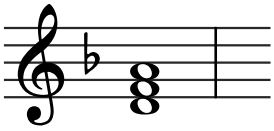
21. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. C major B. D minor C. B minor D. C minor

2 marks

22. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. F♯ minor B. D minor C. D major D. C♯ minor

2 marks

23. What is the relative minor?

C major

A. G minor B. D minor C. C minor D. A minor

2 marks

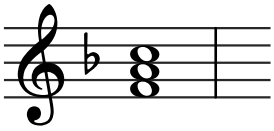
24. What is the relative major?

A minor

A. F major B. A major C. B♭ major D. C major

2 marks

25. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. A♭ major B. F major C. D major D. E♭ major

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "gradually getting louder"?

Find the term

A. ma non troppo B. sforzando (sf) C. grazioso D. crescendo (cresc.)

1 mark
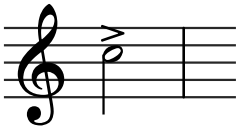
27. What does this mean?

marcato

A. emphatic, accented B. suddenly C. as fast as possible D. too much

1 mark

28. What does this sign mean?



A. accent: play it strongly B. pause: hold the note longer C. diminuendo: gradually getting quieter D. crescendo: gradually getting louder

1 mark
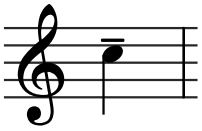
29. What does this mean?

risoluto

A. slow B. boldly C. moderately loud D. repeat from the beginning and stop at Fine

1 mark

30. What does this sign mean?

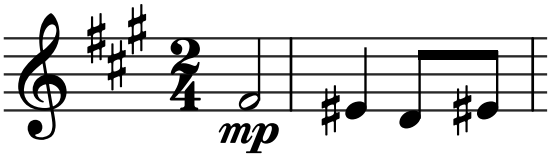


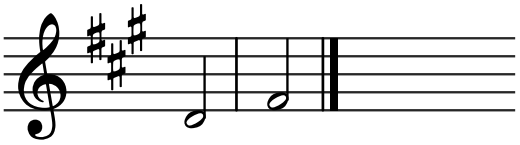
A. gradually getting quieter B. hold the note for its full length C. play an octave higher than written D. gradually getting louder

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Allegro





2 marks

31. Which key is this melody in?

A. A♭ major B. B♭ major C. F major D. F♯ minor

2 marks

32. How many beats are in each bar, and what is the beat?

A. 4 crotchets B. 2 dotted crotchets C. 2 crotchets D. 6 quavers

2 marks

33. What does "Allegro" mean?

A. very, much B. too much C. fast, lively D. loud, then immediately quiet

2 marks

34. Which is the highest note in the melody?

A. E♯ B. D C. F♯

2 marks

35. What does "Allegro" mean?

A. very, much B. too much C. fast, lively D. loud, then immediately quiet

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **D: 3 crotchets**. 3/4 is simple: the 4 means a crotchet beat, and there are 3 of them.
2. S1 · 3m **A: After note 2**. A bar of 2/4 holds 2 crotchet beats. Notes 1 to 2 fill it exactly, so the bar line goes after note 2.
3. S1 · 3m **A: 24**. A dotted semibreve lasts 6 crotchet beats. A semiquaver lasts ¼. 6 ÷ ¼ = 24.
4. S1 · 3m **C: After note 2**. A bar of 6/8 holds two dotted-crotchet beats (6 quavers). Notes 1 to 2 fill it exactly, so the bar line goes after note 2.
5. S1 · 3m **B: grouped correctly**. 3/4 has three crotchet beats, so the quavers go in pairs, one pair per beat. Groups of three make it look like 6/8.
6. S2 · 3m **G♯**. G♯. Landmark: middle C, on its own little line above the stave. This note is 4 steps above it: C, D, E, F, G. The sharp makes it G♯.
7. S2 · 3m **E (bass clef, 5 steps below middle C)**. Note 5 of A major is E.
8. S2 · 3m **C**. C. It's the landmark C: two ledger lines above.
9. S2 · 3m **C (bass clef, 14 steps below middle C)**. Same letter, 7 steps down: C.
10. S2 · 3m **B: Below middle C**. In the bass clef, middle C is on the first ledger line above the stave. This note is B, 8 steps below it.
11. S3 · 2m **B: A minor**. No sharps or flats. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is A minor.
12. S3 · 2m **7**. Note 7 should be A♯, not A. Melodic minor raises the 6th and 7th going up.
13. S3 · 2m **B: E♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is E♭, so E♭ major.
14. S3 · 2m **B: A major**. It starts and ends on A. It follows tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone, so it's major.
15. S3 · 2m **C: B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭**. A♭ major: B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭. Flats always come in the order B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭ G♭ C♭ F♭.
16. S4 · 2m **C: B♭**. Count 3 letters up from G to get B. A minor 3rd is 3 semitones, so it's B♭.
17. S4 · 2m **C: D♭**. Count 7 letters up from E♭ to get D. A minor 7th is 10 semitones, so it's D♭.
18. S4 · 2m **A: perfect 5th**. Count the letters C D E F G: that's a 5th. 7 semitones, so it's a perfect 5th.
19. S4 · 2m **C: minor 6th**. Count the letters G A B C D E: that's a 6th. 8 semitones, so it's a minor 6th.
20. S4 · 2m **C: perfect 4th**. Count the letters C D E F: that's a 4th. 5 semitones, so it's a perfect 4th.
21. S5 · 2m **D: C minor**. The bottom note is the tonic, C. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of C minor.
22. S5 · 2m **B: D minor**. The bottom note is the tonic, D. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of D minor.
23. S5 · 2m **D: A minor**. Count up to note 6 of C major: A. Both keys share the same key signature.
24. S5 · 2m **D: C major**. The relative major starts on note 3 of the minor scale: C major.
25. S5 · 2m **B: F major**. The bottom note is the tonic, F. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of F major.
26. S6 · 1m **D: crescendo (cresc.)**. crescendo (cresc.) is Italian for "gradually getting louder".
27. S6 · 1m **A: emphatic, accented**. marcato is Italian for "emphatic, accented".
28. S6 · 1m **A: accent: play it strongly**. It means accent: play it strongly.
29. S6 · 1m **B: boldly**. risoluto is Italian for "boldly".

30. S6 · 1m **B: hold the note for its full length**. That's a tenuto: hold the note for its full length.
31. S7 · 2m **D: F♯ minor**. The key signature has 3 sharps, the raised 7th (E♯) shows it's minor, and the melody ends on F♯: F♯ minor.
32. S7 · 2m **C: 2 crotchets**. 2/4 has 2 crotchet beats in each bar.
33. S7 · 2m **C: fast, lively**. Allegro means fast, lively.
34. S7 · 2m **C: F♯**. The highest note is F♯, in bar 1.
35. S7 · 2m **C: fast, lively**. Allegro means fast, lively.

Grade 4 practice paper

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks
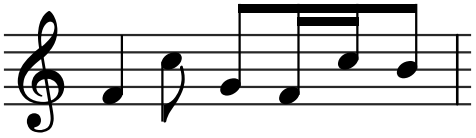
1. A duplet of quavers (marked 2) takes the time of how many ordinary quavers?

Duplet

A. 2 B. 4 C. 3 D. 6

3 marks
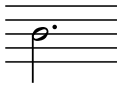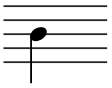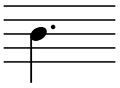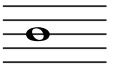
2. Which time signature fits this bar?



A. 6/8 B. 2/2 C. 4/4 D. 12/8
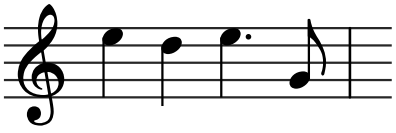
3 marks

3. Which note lasts as long as three crotchets?

A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks
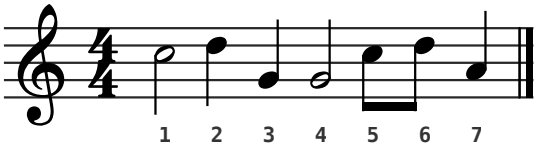
4. Which time signature fits this bar?



A. 3/4 B. 9/8 C. 2/2 D. 6/8

3 marks

5. The first bar line is missing. Where does it go?

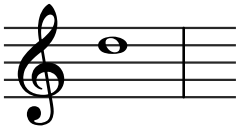


A. After note 4 B. After note 2 C. After note 3 D. After note 5

Section 2: Pitch (15 marks)

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Treble clef)

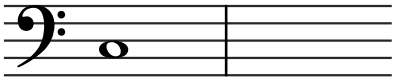


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

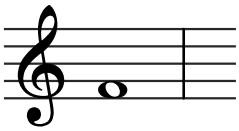
7. Write a note an octave above this note. (Bass clef · letter name only)

Write your answer on this stave:
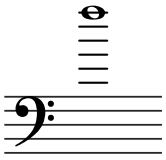


3 marks
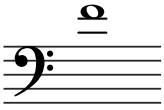
8. Which is the same note, written in bass clef? (Treble clef)
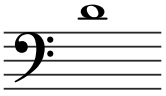


A.
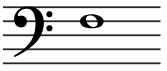


B.



C.



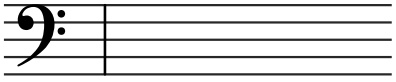
D.



3 marks
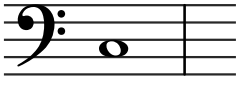
9. Write D on the stave. (Bass clef · any octave)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

10. Name this note. (Bass clef)
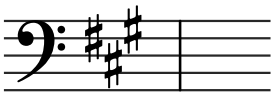


Write your answer: _____

Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks

11. Which major key has this key signature? (Bass clef)



A. A major B. F major C. E major D. A♭ major
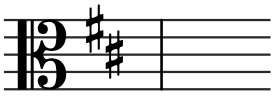
2 marks

12. Which note sounds the same as D♯?

A. E♭ B. E𝄫 C. C♯ D. D♭

2 marks
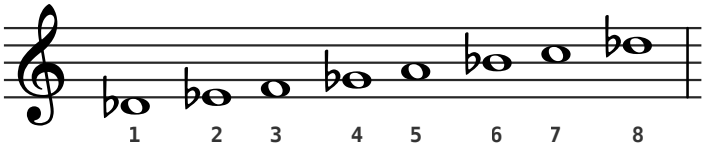
13. Which minor key has this key signature? (Alto clef)



A. B minor B. D minor C. F minor D. E minor

2 marks
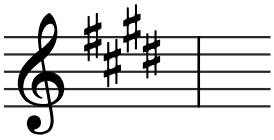
14. One note in this D♭ major scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____

2 marks

15. Which major key has this key signature? (Treble clef)

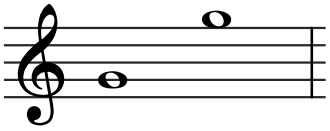


A. E major B. D♭ major C. C major D. D major

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (G up to G)



A. augmented octave B. major 9th C. perfect octave D. major 7th

2 marks

17. Which note is an augmented 4th above C?

A. F𝄪 B. F♯ C. G♯ D. E♯

2 marks

18. Which note is a minor 3rd above A♯?

A. C𝄪 B. B♯ C. C♯ D. C
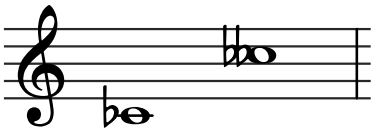
2 marks

19. Which note is a perfect 5th above F♭?

A. C𝄫 B. C♭ C. B♭ D. C

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (C♭ up to C𝄫)

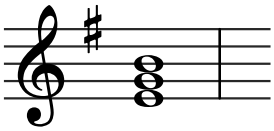


A. diminished 7th B. diminished 9th C. augmented octave D. diminished octave

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks

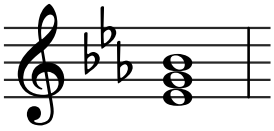
21. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. B minor B. D minor C. F minor D. E minor

2 marks

22. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. E♭ major B. D major C. D♭ major D. B♭ major

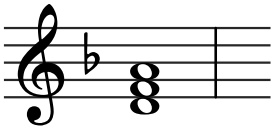
2 marks

23. What is the dominant note of D major?

A. A B. B C. E D. G

2 marks

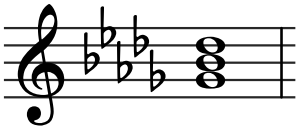
24. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. A minor B. F♯ minor C. G♯ minor D. D minor

2 marks

25. Name this chord in D♭ major.



A. I B. IV C. V

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. What does this mean?

simile

A. in the same way B. the end C. very fast D. lightly

1 mark
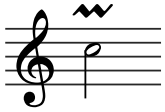
27. Which term means "with some freedom of time"?
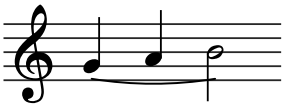
Find the term
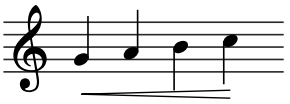
A. rubato B. mezzo forte (mf) C. come prima D. presto
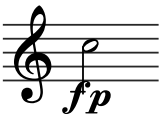
1 mark

28. Which picture shows a fortepiano (fp)?

A. 

B. 

C. 

D. 

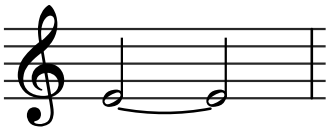
1 mark

29. Which clef does the timpani usually read?

A. bass B. tenor C. alto D. treble

1 mark

30. Is this curved line a tie or a slur?

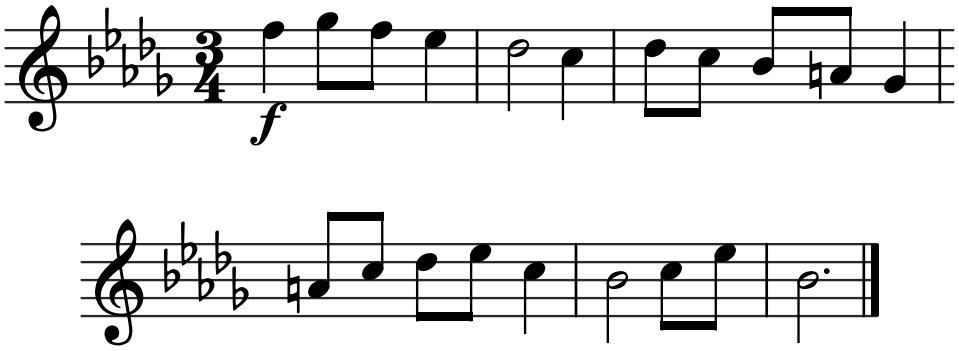


A. Tie B. Slur

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

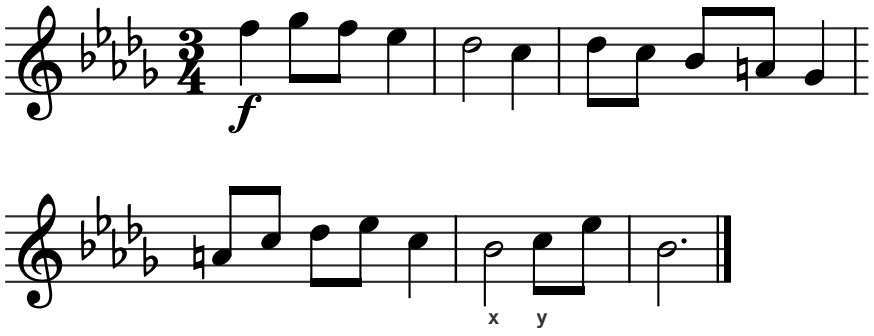
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Lento



2 marks

31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. diminished 2nd B. major 3rd C. major 2nd D. minor 2nd

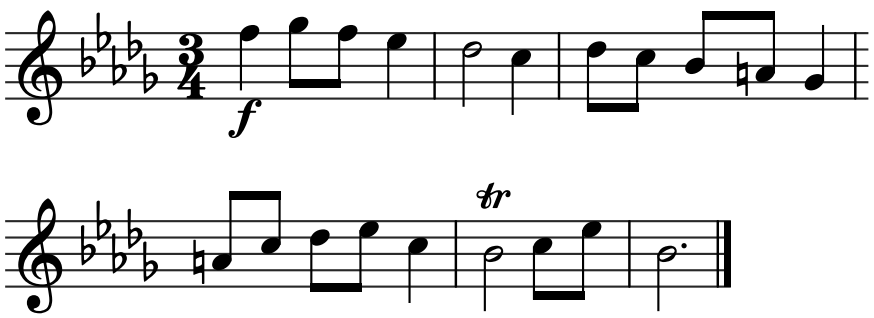
2 marks

32. Which is the highest note in the melody?

A. C B. G♭ C. F D. B♭

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 5 called?



A. acciaccatura B. trill C. turn D. upper mordent

2 marks

34. What does "Lento" mean?

A. held B. smoothly C. slow D. very loud

2 marks

35. What does f under the first note mean?

A. moderately loud B. moderately quiet C. loud D. very loud

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **C: 3**. A duplet fits two quavers into the time of three, in compound time.
2. S1 · 3m **A: 6/8**. The notes add up to 2 dotted crotchet beats, so 6/8 fits.
3. S1 · 3m **A: dotted minim**. Three crotchets last 3 beats, the same as a dotted minim.
4. S1 · 3m **C: 2/2**. The notes add up to 2 minim beats, so 2/2 fits.
5. S1 · 3m **C: After note 3**. A bar of 4/4 holds 4 crotchet beats. Notes 1 to 3 fill it exactly, so the bar line goes after note 3.
6. S2 · 3m **D**. D. Landmark: C, the third space. This note is 1 step above it: C, D.
7. S2 · 3m **C (bass clef, middle C)**. Count 8 letter names up from C, counting both notes: C D E F G A B C. The answer is C.
8. S2 · 3m **B: bass clef note F4**. It's F, at exactly the same pitch. Watch out for the one an octave away: same letter, wrong place.
9. S2 · 3m **D**. D can go in more than one octave; any D was fine.
10. S2 · 3m **C**. C. It's the landmark C: the second space.
11. S3 · 2m **A: A major**. The last sharp is G♯. One step up from it is A, so A major.
12. S3 · 2m **A: E♭**. D♯ and E♭ are enharmonic equivalents: the same key on the piano, written with a different letter name.
13. S3 · 2m **A: B minor**. The last sharp is C♯. One step up from it is D, so D major. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is B minor.
14. S3 · 2m **5**. Note 5 should be A♭, not A. Major scales go tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.
15. S3 · 2m **A: E major**. The last sharp is D♯. One step up from it is E, so E major.
16. S4 · 2m **C: perfect octave**. Count the letters G A B C D E F G: that's an octave. 12 semitones, so it's a perfect octave.
17. S4 · 2m **B: F♯**. Count 4 letters up from C to get F. An augmented 4th is 6 semitones, so it's F♯.
18. S4 · 2m **C: C♯**. Count 3 letters up from A♯ to get C. A minor 3rd is 3 semitones, so it's C♯.
19. S4 · 2m **B: C♭**. Count 5 letters up from F♭ to get C. A perfect 5th is 7 semitones, so it's C♭.
20. S4 · 2m **D: diminished octave**. Count the letters C D E F G A B C: that's an octave. 11 semitones, so it's a diminished octave.
21. S5 · 2m **D: E minor**. The bottom note is the tonic, E. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of E minor.
22. S5 · 2m **A: E♭ major**. The bottom note is the tonic, E♭. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of E♭ major.
23. S5 · 2m **A: A**. The dominant is degree 5: A.
24. S5 · 2m **D: D minor**. The bottom note is the tonic, D. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of D minor.
25. S5 · 2m **B: IV**. The notes are G♭–B♭–D♭, built on degree 4, so it's IV.
26. S6 · 1m **A: in the same way**. simile is Italian for "in the same way".
27. S6 · 1m **A: rubato**. rubato is Italian for "with some freedom of time".
28. S6 · 1m **D: fortepiano (fp)**. Fortepiano (fp) means loud, then quiet straight away.
29. S6 · 1m **A: bass**. The timpani reads bass clef.

30. S6 · 1m **A: Tie**. It joins two notes of the same pitch, so it's a tie: play one long note.
31. S7 · 2m **C: major 2nd**. The notes are B♭ and C: a major 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **B: G♭**. The highest note is G♭, in bar 1.
33. S7 · 2m **B: trill**. The sign above the note in bar 5 is a trill.
34. S7 · 2m **C: slow**. Lento means slow.
35. S7 · 2m **C: loud**. f means loud.

Grade 4 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
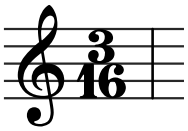
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks

1. How many beats in a bar, and what is the beat?



A. 3 dotted semiquavers B. 3 demisemiquavers C. 3 semiquavers D. 3 quavers

3 marks

2. A melody in 6/8 has every beat split into a duplet. Without the duplets, which time signature would sound the same?

A. 3/4 B. 2/8 C. 2/4 D. 2/2

3 marks
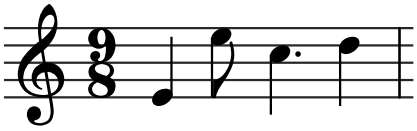
3. A triplet of quavers (marked 3) takes the time of how many ordinary quavers?
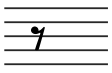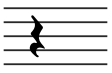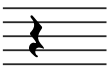
Triplet

A. 3 B. 2 C. 5 D. 6

3 marks

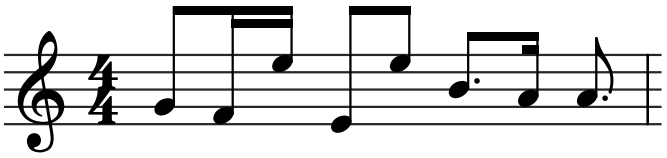
4. Which rest finishes this bar?



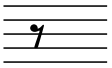
A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks

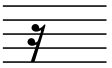
5. Which rest finishes this bar?



A. 

B. 

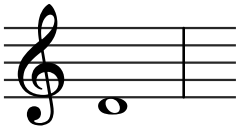
C. 

D. 

Section 2: Pitch **(15 marks)**

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Treble clef)

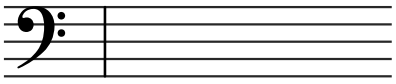


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

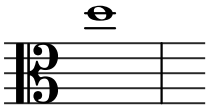
7. Write the tonic (key note) of F major. (Bass clef · any octave)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

8. Name this note. (Alto clef)

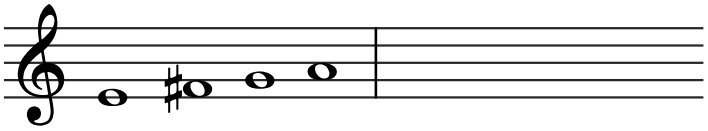


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

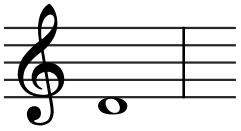
9. Finish the scale of E melodic minor, going up: write notes 5, 6, 7 and 8. (Treble clef · no key signature, so use accidentals)
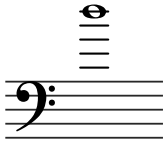
Write your answer on this stave:
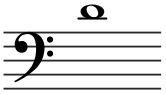


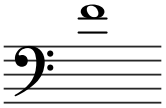
3 marks
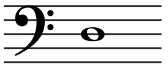
10. Which is the same note, written in bass clef? (Treble clef)



A. 

B. 
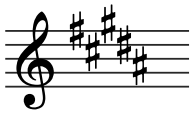
C. 
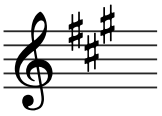
D. 
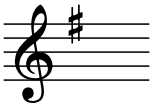
Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)
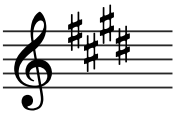
2 marks

11. Which is the key signature of E major?

A. 

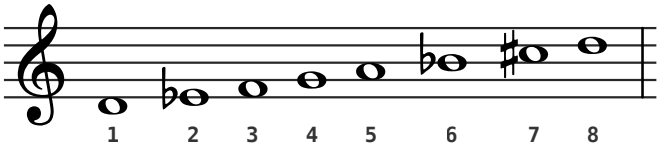
B. 

C. 

D. 

2 marks

12. One note in this D harmonic minor scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____
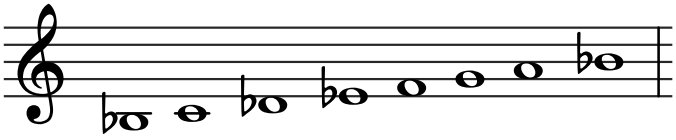
2 marks

13. Which flats are in F major, in order?

A. F♭ B. B♭ E♭ C. E♭ D. B♭

2 marks

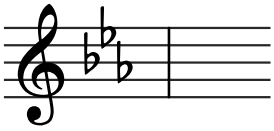
14. Which scale is this? (Going up)



A. G♯ melodic minor B. B♭ harmonic minor C. B♭ melodic minor D. B♭ major

2 marks

15. Which minor key has this key signature? (Treble clef)



A. G♯ minor B. A minor C. F♯ minor D. C minor

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)
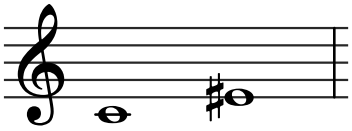
2 marks

16. Which note is a perfect 4th above A♯?

A. D♯ B. E♯ C. C♯ D. D

2 marks

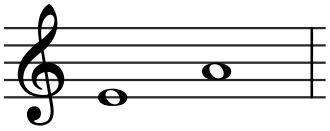
17. Name this interval. (C up to E♯)



A. minor 3rd B. augmented 3rd C. augmented 4th D. augmented 2nd

2 marks

18. Name this interval. (E up to A)



A. augmented 4th B. perfect 4th C. major 3rd D. perfect 5th

2 marks

19. Which note is a minor 6th above E?

A. B B. C C. C♭ D. C♯

2 marks

20. Which note is a perfect octave above D♯?

A. E♯ B. D♯ C. D𝄪 D. D

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

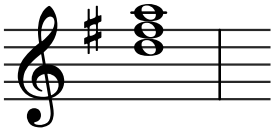
2 marks

21. Spell chord IV in B minor.

A. E–G–B B. B–D–F♯ C. G–B–D D. F♯–A♯–C♯

2 marks

22. Name this chord in G major.



A. I B. IV C. V
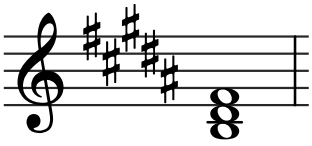
2 marks

23. Spell the tonic triad of G major.

A. G–B–D B. E♭–G–B♭ C. G–B♭–D D. B–D♯–F♯

2 marks

24. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. A major B. B major C. B minor D. D♭ major

2 marks

25. Spell the tonic triad of E♭ major.

A. B–D♯–F♯ B. D–F♯–A C. F–A–C D. E♭–G–B♭

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "with a mute"?

Find the term

A. lent B. adagio C. con sordino D. energico

1 mark
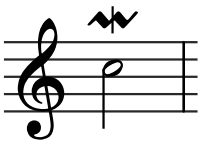
27. What does this mean?

tranquillo

A. calmly B. too much C. at a walking pace D. repeat from the beginning and stop at Fine

1 mark

28. What does this sign mean?



A. strongly accented B. the note, the note below, the note again, quickly C. short and detached D. hold the note for its full length

1 mark

29. Which instrument uses a double reed?

Instruments

A. clarinet B. bassoon C. trumpet D. flute

1 mark

30. Which sign means "very quiet"?
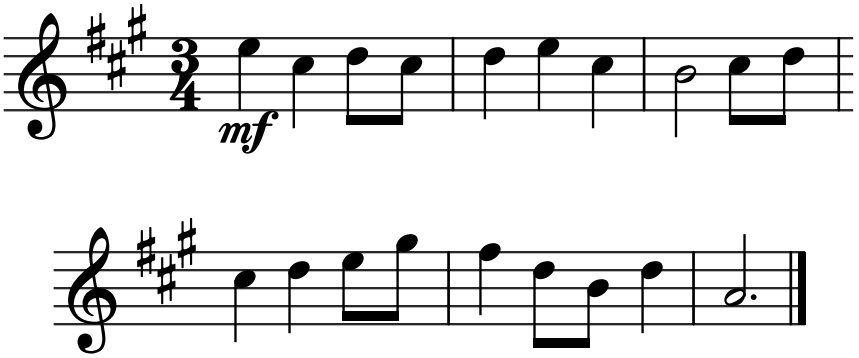
Dynamics

A. pp B. mp C. mf D. f

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)
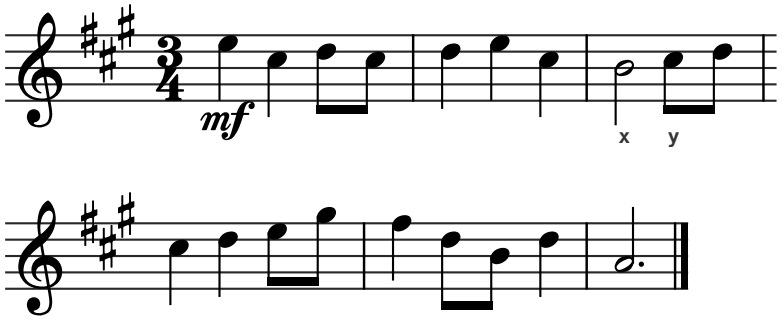
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Allegretto



2 marks

31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. diminished 2nd B. major 3rd C. minor 2nd D. major 2nd

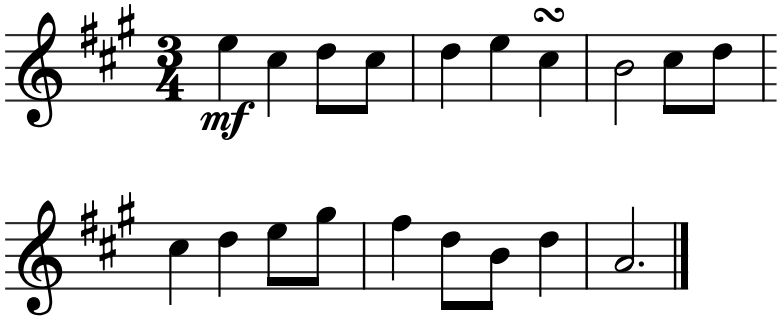
2 marks

32. Which is the highest note in the melody?

A. F♯ B. A C. B D. G♯

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 2 called?



A. upper mordent B. lower mordent C. acciaccatura D. turn

2 marks

34. What does "Allegretto" mean?

A. fairly quick B. at the same speed C. boldly D. sweetly

2 marks

35. What does mf under the first note mean?

A. very quiet B. very loud C. quiet D. moderately loud

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **C: 3 semiquavers**. 3/16 is simple: the 16 means a semiquaver beat, and there are 3 of them.
2. S1 · 3m **C: 2/4**. 6/8 has 2 dotted beats. Split in 2 instead of 3, they're plain crotchet beats: 2/4.
3. S1 · 3m **B: 2**. Three quavers in a triplet take the time of two.
4. S1 · 3m **A: quaver rest**. A bar of 9/8 holds 3 dotted crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one quaver, so a quaver rest finishes it.
5. S1 · 3m **D: semiquaver rest**. A bar of 4/4 holds 4 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one semiquaver, so a semiquaver rest finishes it.
6. S2 · 3m **D**. D. Landmark: middle C, on its own little line below the stave. This note is 1 step above it: C, D.
7. S2 · 3m **F**. The tonic of F major is F.
8. S2 · 3m **D**. D. Landmark: B, one ledger line above. This note is 2 steps above it: B, C, D.
9. S2 · 3m **B, C♯, D♯, E (treble clef)**. Notes 5 to 8 of E melodic minor are B, C♯, D♯, E.
10. S2 · 3m **B: bass clef note D4**. It's D, at exactly the same pitch. Watch out for the one an octave away: same letter, wrong place.
11. S3 · 2m **D: 4 sharps**. E major has 4 sharps.
12. S3 · 2m **2**. Note 2 should be E, not E♭. Harmonic minor raises the 7th.
13. S3 · 2m **D: B♭**. F major: B♭. Flats always come in the order B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭ G♭ C♭ F♭.
14. S3 · 2m **C: B♭ melodic minor**. It starts and ends on B♭. The 6th and 7th are raised going up, so it's melodic minor.
15. S3 · 2m **D: C minor**. The second-to-last flat is E♭, so E♭ major. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is C minor.
16. S4 · 2m **A: D♯**. Count 4 letters up from A♯ to get D. A perfect 4th is 5 semitones, so it's D♯.
17. S4 · 2m **B: augmented 3rd**. Count the letters C D E: that's a 3rd. 5 semitones, so it's an augmented 3rd.
18. S4 · 2m **B: perfect 4th**. Count the letters E F G A: that's a 4th. 5 semitones, so it's a perfect 4th.
19. S4 · 2m **B: C**. Count 6 letters up from E to get C. A minor 6th is 8 semitones, so it's C.
20. S4 · 2m **B: D♯**. Count 8 letters up from D♯ to get D. A perfect octave is 12 semitones, so it's D♯.
21. S5 · 2m **A: E–G–B**. Chord IV is built on degree 4, the subdominant: E–G–B.
22. S5 · 2m **C: V**. The notes are D–F♯–A, built on degree 5, so it's V.
23. S5 · 2m **A: G–B–D**. Notes 1, 3 and 5 of G major: G–B–D.
24. S5 · 2m **B: B major**. The bottom note is the tonic, B. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of B major.
25. S5 · 2m **D: E♭–G–B♭**. Notes 1, 3 and 5 of E♭ major: E♭–G–B♭.
26. S6 · 1m **C: con sordino**. con sordino is Italian for "with a mute".
27. S6 · 1m **A: calmly**. tranquillo is Italian for "calmly".
28. S6 · 1m **B: the note, the note below, the note again, quickly**. That's a lower mordent: the note, the note below, the note again, quickly.
29. S6 · 1m **B: bassoon**. The oboe and the bassoon use double reeds.
30. S6 · 1m **A: pp**. pp means very quiet.
31. S7 · 2m **D: major 2nd**. The notes are B and C♯: a major 2nd.

32. S7 · 2m **D: G♯**. The highest note is G♯, in bar 4.
33. S7 · 2m **D: turn**. The sign above the note in bar 2 is a turn.
34. S7 · 2m **A: fairly quick**. Allegretto means fairly quick.
35. S7 · 2m **D: moderately loud**. mf means moderately loud.

Grade 5 practice paper 1

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks
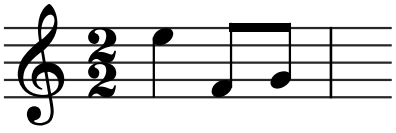
1. A dotted minim tied to a crotchet. How many crotchet beats is that?

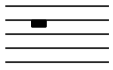
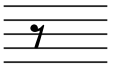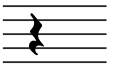
Ties

A. 4 B. 4½ C. 8 D. 5

3 marks

2. Which rest finishes this bar?



A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks
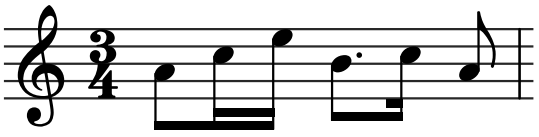
3. Which of these is an irregular time signature?

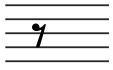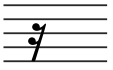
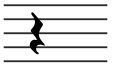
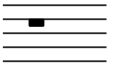
Irregular time

A. 12/8 B. 4/4 C. 5/4 D. 6/8

3 marks
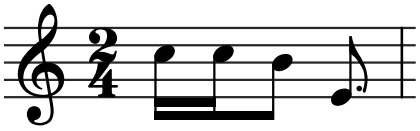
4. Which rest finishes this bar?

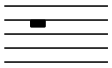


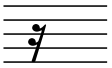
A.  B.  C.  D. 
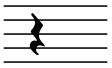
3 marks

5. Which rest finishes this bar?



A. 

B. 

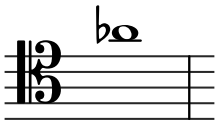
C. 

D. 

Section 2: Pitch **(15 marks)**

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Tenor clef)



Write your answer: _____

3 marks
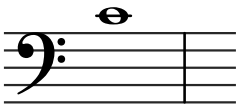
7. Write a note an octave above this note. (Treble clef · letter name only)
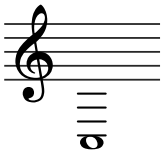
Write your answer on this stave:
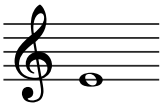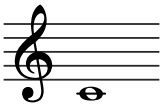


3 marks
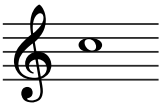
8. Which is the same note, written in treble clef? (Bass clef)



A. 

B. 

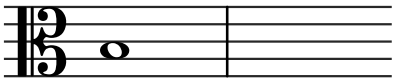
C. 

D. 

3 marks

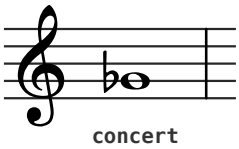
9. Write a diminished 6th above this note. (Alto clef)

Write your answer on this stave:

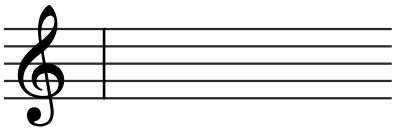


3 marks

10. This note is at concert pitch. Write it for trumpet in B♭. (Treble clef · use an accidental if it needs one)
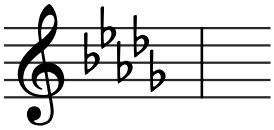


Write your answer on this stave:



Section 3: Keys and scales **(10 marks)**

2 marks
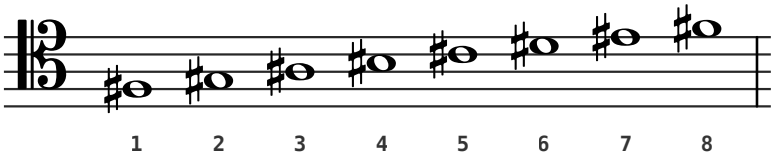
11. Which minor key has this key signature? (Treble clef)



A. B minor B. G♯ minor C. D♯ minor D. B♭ minor

2 marks
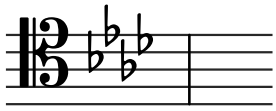
12. One note in this F♯ major scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____

2 marks

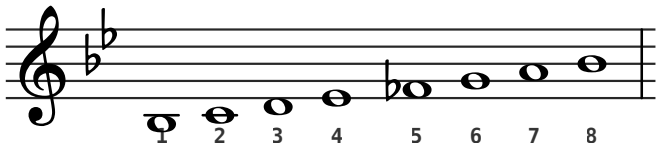
13. Which major key has this key signature? (Tenor clef)



A. D♭ major B. B♭ major C. E major D. A♭ major

2 marks
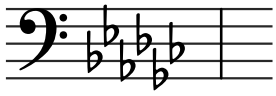
14. One note in this B♭ major scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____

2 marks

15. Which major key has this key signature? (Bass clef)

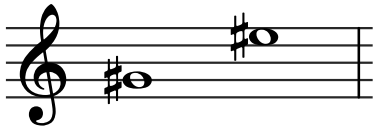


A. D major B. G♭ major C. B major D. D♭ major

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (G♯ up to E♯)



A. perfect 5th B. major 7th C. major 6th D. diminished 6th

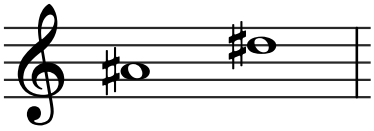
2 marks

17. Which note is an augmented 5th above G?

A. E♯ B. D C. C♯ D. D♯

2 marks
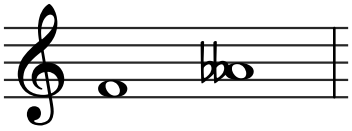
18. Name this interval. (A♯ up to D♯)



A. perfect 5th B. diminished 4th C. major 3rd D. perfect 4th

2 marks
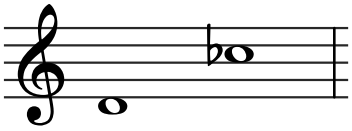
19. Name this interval. (F up to A𝄫)



A. augmented 3rd B. major 3rd C. diminished 3rd D. diminished 2nd

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (D up to C♭)
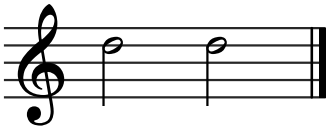


A. diminished 7th B. diminished 6th C. minor 7th D. diminished octave

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks

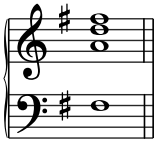
21. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in C major. Which chords make an imperfect cadence?



A. I–V B. II–V C. IV–I D. V–I

2 marks
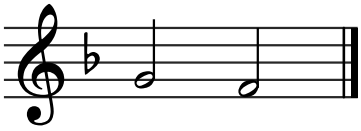
22. Name this chord in G major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. IIb B. Vb C. Ib D. IVb

2 marks

23. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in F major. Which chords make a perfect cadence?



A. IV–I B. IV–V C. V–I D. I–V

2 marks
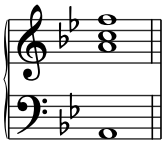
24. Which cadence is this?

I–V

A. imperfect B. perfect C. plagal

2 marks

25. Name this chord in B♭ major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. IIb B. Va C. Vb D. Ib

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. What does this mean?

perdendosi

A. dying away, fading B. not C. reinforcing, with a sudden accent D. broadening, getting slower

1 mark

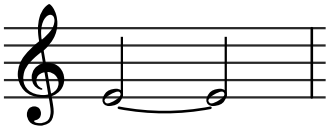
27. What does this mean?

ritmico

A. with the bow B. gradually getting quieter C. expressively D. rhythmically

1 mark

28. Is this curved line a tie or a slur?



A. Slur B. Tie

1 mark
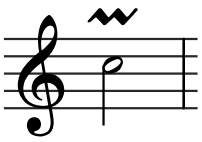
29. Which woodwind instrument plays highest?

Instruments

A. bassoon B. piccolo C. clarinet D. oboe

1 mark

30. What does this sign mean?
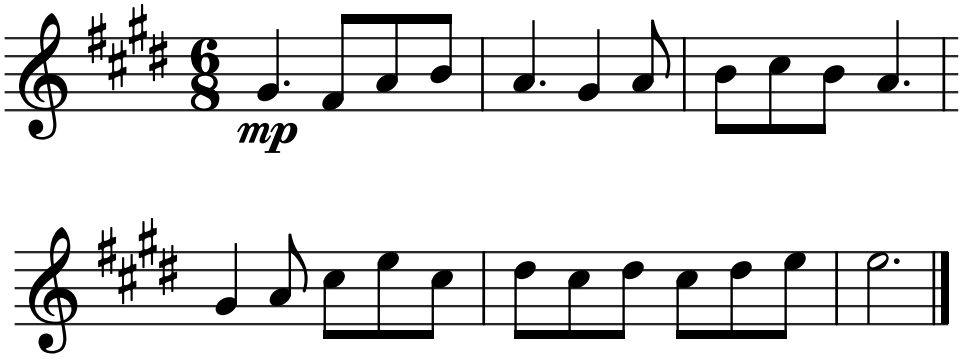


A. a sudden strong accent B. the note, the note above, the note again, quickly C. jump to the coda, the ending section D. the note, the note below, the note again, quickly

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

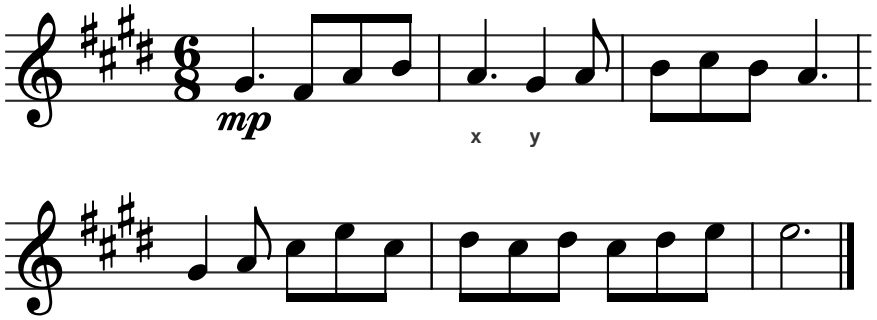
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Animé



2 marks

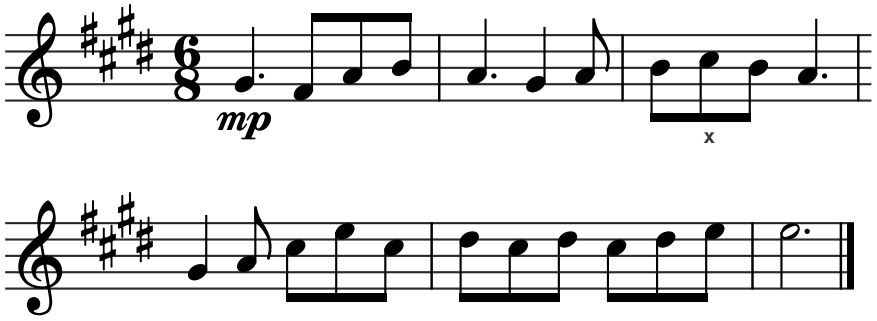
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. minor 2nd B. major 3rd C. diminished 2nd D. major 2nd

2 marks

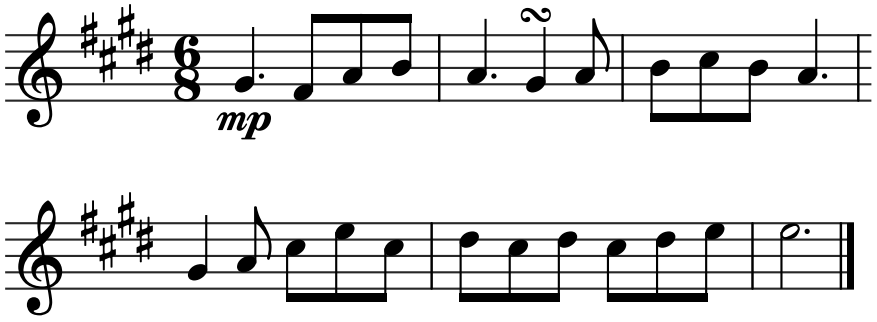
32. The melody is in E major. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. leading note B. submediant C. tonic D. dominant

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 2 called?



A. trill B. turn C. acciaccatura D. upper mordent

2 marks

34. What does "Animé" mean?

A. moderately quiet B. animated, lively C. repeat from the beginning D. less

2 marks

35. What does mp under the first note mean?

A. moderately quiet B. very loud C. loud D. quiet

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **A: 4**. A tie joins the two notes into one sound: 3 + 1 = 4 beats.
2. S1 · 3m **B: minim rest**. A bar of 2/2 holds 2 minim beats. The notes leave a gap of one minim, so a minim rest finishes it.
3. S1 · 3m **C: 5/4**. 5/4 can't be split into equal groups of 2 or 3, so it's irregular.
4. S1 · 3m **A: quaver rest**. A bar of 3/4 holds 3 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one quaver, so a quaver rest finishes it.
5. S1 · 3m **B: semiquaver rest**. A bar of 2/4 holds 2 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one semiquaver, so a semiquaver rest finishes it.
6. S2 · 3m **A♭**. A♭. Landmark: G, one ledger line above. This note is 1 step above it: G, A. The flat makes it A♭.
7. S2 · 3m **A (treble clef, 12 steps above middle C)**. Count 8 letter names up from A, counting both notes: A B C D E F G A. The answer is A.
8. S2 · 3m **C: treble clef note C4**. It's C (middle C), at exactly the same pitch. Watch out for the one an octave away: same letter, wrong place.
9. S2 · 3m **G♭ (alto clef, 4 steps above middle C)**. Count 6 letter names up from B: the answer is G♭.
10. S2 · 3m **A♭ (treble clef, 5 steps above middle C)**. The trumpet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower than it reads, so write it a major 2nd higher: G♭ goes up to A♭.
11. S3 · 2m **D: B♭ minor**. The second-to-last flat is D♭, so D♭ major. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is B♭ minor.
12. S3 · 2m **4**. Note 4 should be B, not B♯. Major scales go tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.
13. S3 · 2m **D: A♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is A♭, so A♭ major.
14. S3 · 2m **5**. Note 5 should be F, not F♭. Major scales go tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.
15. S3 · 2m **B: G♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is G♭, so G♭ major.
16. S4 · 2m **C: major 6th**. Count the letters G A B C D E: that's a 6th. 9 semitones, so it's a major 6th.
17. S4 · 2m **D: D♯**. Count 5 letters up from G to get D. An augmented 5th is 8 semitones, so it's D♯.
18. S4 · 2m **D: perfect 4th**. Count the letters A B C D: that's a 4th. 5 semitones, so it's a perfect 4th.
19. S4 · 2m **C: diminished 3rd**. Count the letters F G A: that's a 3rd. 2 semitones, so it's a diminished 3rd.
20. S4 · 2m **A: diminished 7th**. Count the letters D E F G A B C: that's a 7th. 9 semitones, so it's a diminished 7th.
21. S5 · 2m **B: II–V**. The first note, D, is in chord II (D–F–A). The second, D, is in chord V (G–B–D). II–V makes an imperfect cadence.
22. S5 · 2m **B: Vb**. Put the notes in 3rds: D–F♯–A. The root is D, degree 5, so it's chord V. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is F♯: the 3rd, so b.
23. S5 · 2m **C: V–I**. The first note, G, is in chord V (C–E–G). The second, F, is in chord I (F–A–C). V–I makes a perfect cadence.
24. S5 · 2m **A: imperfect**. It ends on V, so it's imperfect and sounds unfinished.
25. S5 · 2m **C: Vb**. Put the notes in 3rds: F–A–C. The root is F, degree 5, so it's chord V. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is A: the 3rd, so b.
26. S6 · 1m **A: dying away, fading**. perdendosi is Italian for "dying away, fading".
27. S6 · 1m **D: rhythmically**. ritmico is Italian for "rhythmically".
28. S6 · 1m **B: Tie**. It joins two notes of the same pitch, so it's a tie: play one long note.

29. S6 · 1m **B: piccolo**. The piccolo is a small flute and plays an octave above the flute.
30. S6 · 1m **B: the note, the note above, the note again, quickly**. That's an upper mordent: the note, the note above, the note again, quickly.
31. S7 · 2m **A: minor 2nd**. The notes are A and G♯: a minor 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **B: submediant**. The note marked x is C♯. Counting up from E, that's degree 6, the submediant.
33. S7 · 2m **B: turn**. The sign above the note in bar 2 is a turn.
34. S7 · 2m **B: animated, lively**. Animé means animated, lively.
35. S7 · 2m **A: moderately quiet**. mp means moderately quiet.

Grade 5 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
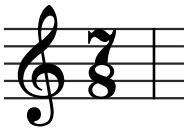
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks

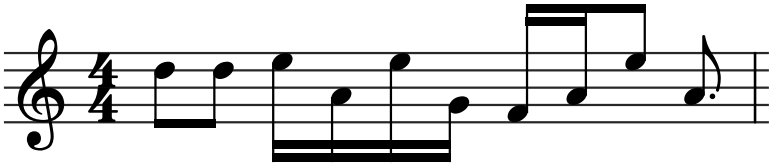
1. What kind of time signature is this?

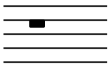
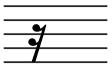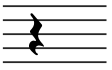


A. simple duple B. irregular C. simple quadruple D. compound duple

3 marks
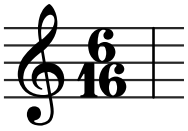
2. Which rest finishes this bar?



A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks
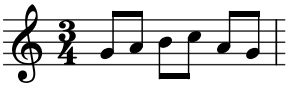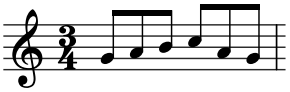
3. What kind of time signature is this?



A. simple triple B. compound duple C. simple quadruple D. simple duple
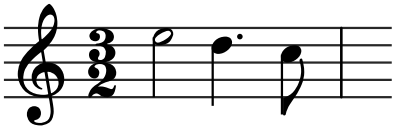
3 marks

4. Which bar is grouped correctly for 3/4?
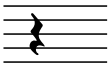
A.  B. 

3 marks

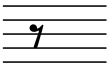
5. Which rest finishes this bar?



A. 

B. 
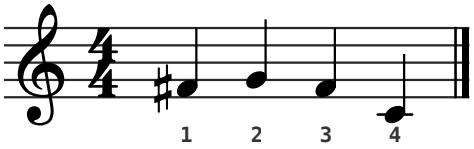
C. 

D. 

Section 2: Pitch **(15 marks)**

3 marks

6. What is note 3? (Treble clef)

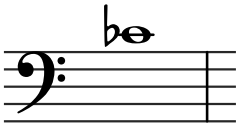


A. F

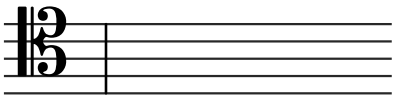
B. F♯

3 marks

7. Write this note at the same pitch in tenor clef. (Given in bass clef)

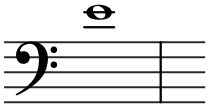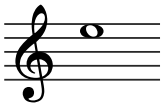


Write your answer on this stave:
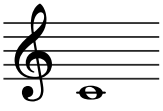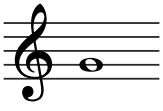


3 marks
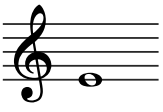
8. Which is the same note, written in treble clef? (Bass clef)



A. 

B. 

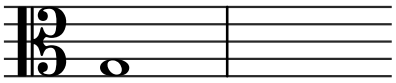
C. 

D. 

3 marks

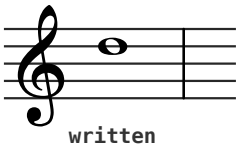
9. Write a minor 7th above this note. (Alto clef)

Write your answer on this stave:

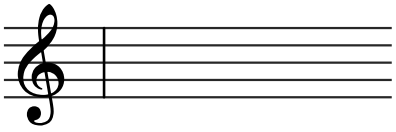


3 marks

10. This is written for horn in F. Write the note that actually sounds. (Treble clef, concert pitch · use an accidental if it needs one)
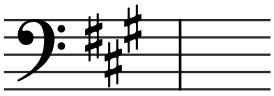


Write your answer on this stave:



Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks

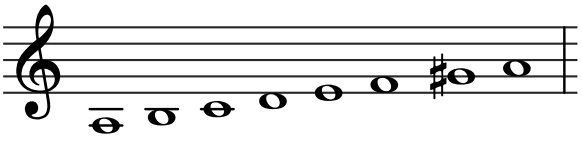
11. Which major key has this key signature? (Bass clef)



A. C major B. F major C. A major D. G♭ major

2 marks

12. Which scale is this?



A. A melodic minor B. F♯ harmonic minor C. A major D. A harmonic minor
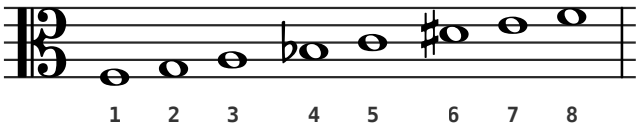
2 marks

13. How many flats are in the key signature of C minor?

Write your answer: _____

2 marks
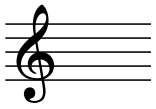
14. One note in this F major scale is wrong. Which number is it?
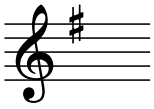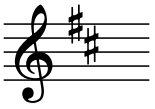


Write your answer: _____
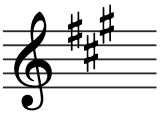
2 marks

15. Which is the key signature of G major?

A. 

B. 
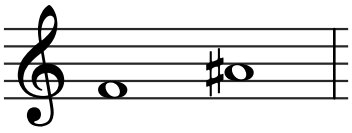
C. 

D. 

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (F up to A♯)



A. augmented 3rd B. augmented 4th C. augmented 2nd D. minor 3rd

2 marks

17. Which note is a perfect 5th above C?

A. G♯ B. A C. G D. G♭
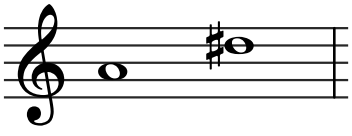
2 marks

18. Which note is an augmented 2nd above G?

A. A♯ B. B♯ C. A𝄪 D. A

2 marks

19. Name this interval. (A up to D♯)



A. augmented 5th B. diminished 4th C. augmented 4th D. augmented 3rd

2 marks

20. Which note is a perfect octave above F♭?

A. F𝄫 B. F♭ C. G♭ D. E♭

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)
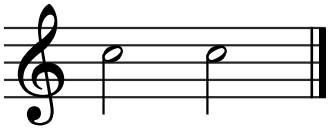
2 marks

21. Which note is in the bass of IVa in C major?

A. E B. C C. F D. A

2 marks

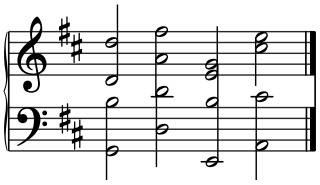
22. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in C major. Which chords make a plagal cadence?



A. V–I B. II–V C. IV–I D. IV–V

2 marks
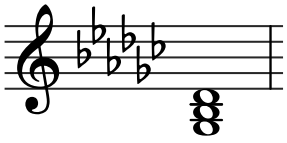
23. This phrase is in D major, for four voices. Which cadence ends it?



A. plagal B. perfect C. imperfect

2 marks
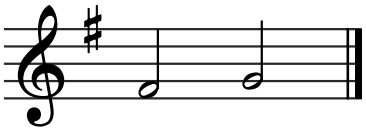
24. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. C major B. F major C. G♭ major D. A major

2 marks

25. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in G major. Which chords make a perfect cadence?



A. II–V B. V–I C. IV–V D. IV–I

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. What does this mean?

attacca

A. simply B. play an octave higher C. go straight on to the next section D. as if, almost

1 mark

27. What does this mean?

douce

A. at the first speed B. as if, almost C. sweet D. heavily

1 mark

28. A tiny note with a slash through its stem, played as quickly as possible before the main note, is called:

Grace notes

A. mordent B. acciaccatura C. appoggiatura D. turn
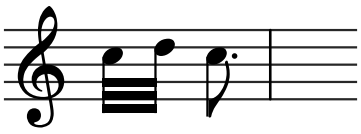
1 mark
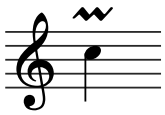
29. Which family does the bassoon belong to?
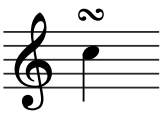
A. woodwind B. percussion C. brass D. strings
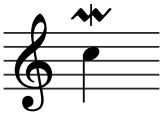
1 mark
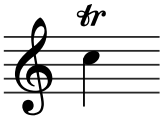
30. These notes are a written-out ornament. Which sign means the same?



A. 

B. 
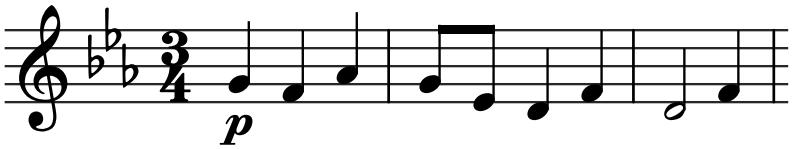
C. 
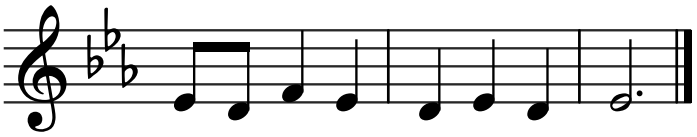
D. 

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

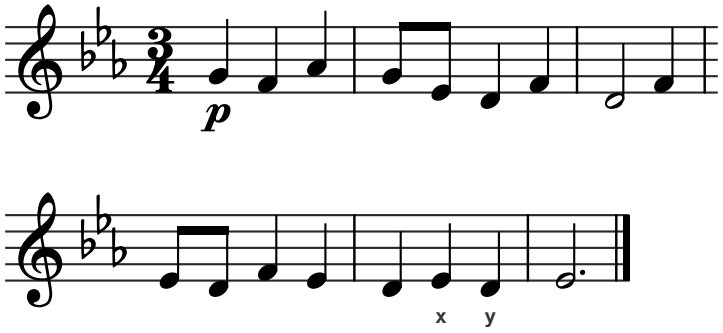
Modéré





2 marks

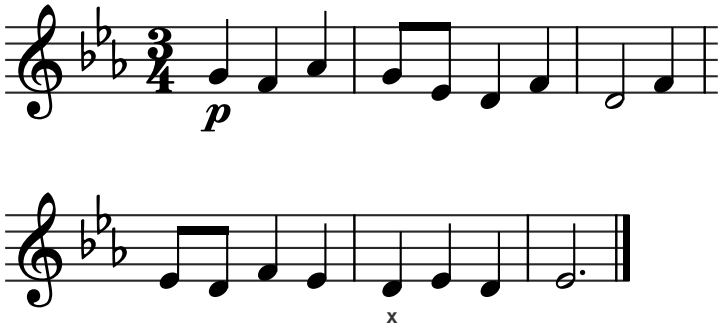
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. minor 2nd B. major 2nd C. diminished 2nd D. major 3rd

2 marks

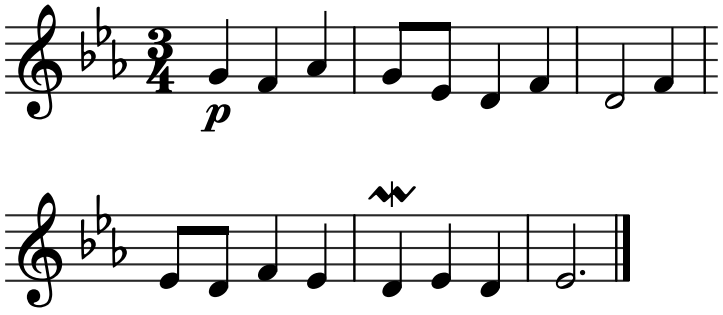
32. The melody is in E♭ major. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. tonic B. leading note C. supertonic D. dominant

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 5 called?



A. lower mordent B. trill C. upper mordent D. turn

2 marks

34. What does "Modéré" mean?

A. loud, then immediately quiet B. majestically C. but not too much D. at a moderate speed

2 marks

35. What does p under the first note mean?

A. quiet B. moderately quiet C. loud D. moderately loud

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **B: irregular**. 7 doesn't split into equal groups of 2 or 3, so 7/8 is irregular. Group it as 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2.
2. S1 · 3m **C: semiquaver rest**. A bar of 4/4 holds 4 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one semiquaver, so a semiquaver rest finishes it.
3. S1 · 3m **B: compound duple**. The top number divides by 3, so it's compound: 6 ÷ 3 = 2 beats, which is duple.
4. S1 · 3m **A: grouped correctly**. 3/4 has three crotchet beats, so the quavers go in pairs, one pair per beat. Groups of three make it look like 6/8.
5. S1 · 3m **C: minim rest**. A bar of 3/2 holds 3 minim beats. The notes leave a gap of one minim, so a minim rest finishes it.
6. S2 · 3m **B: F♯**. The sharp on note 1 lasts for the rest of the bar, so note 3 is F♯ too.
7. S2 · 3m **C♭ (tenor clef, middle C)**. It's C♭, 0 step below middle C. In tenor clef middle C is the 4th line, so count from there.
8. S2 · 3m **D: treble clef note E4**. It's E, at exactly the same pitch. Watch out for the one an octave away: same letter, wrong place.
9. S2 · 3m **F (alto clef, 3 steps above middle C)**. Count 7 letter names up from G: the answer is F.
10. S2 · 3m **G (treble clef, 4 steps above middle C)**. The horn in F sounds a perfect 5th lower than written: D sounds as G.
11. S3 · 2m **C: A major**. The last sharp is G♯. One step up from it is A, so A major.
12. S3 · 2m **D: A harmonic minor**. It starts and ends on A. Only the 7th is raised, so it's harmonic minor.
13. S3 · 2m **3**. C minor has 3 flats: B♭, E♭, A♭.
14. S3 · 2m **6**. Note 6 should be D, not D♯. Major scales go tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.
15. S3 · 2m **B: 1 sharps**. G major has 1 sharp.
16. S4 · 2m **A: augmented 3rd**. Count the letters F G A: that's a 3rd. 5 semitones, so it's an augmented 3rd.
17. S4 · 2m **C: G**. Count 5 letters up from C to get G. A perfect 5th is 7 semitones, so it's G.
18. S4 · 2m **A: A♯**. Count 2 letters up from G to get A. An augmented 2nd is 3 semitones, so it's A♯.
19. S4 · 2m **C: augmented 4th**. Count the letters A B C D: that's a 4th. 6 semitones, so it's an augmented 4th.
20. S4 · 2m **B: F♭**. Count 8 letters up from F♭ to get F. A perfect octave is 12 semitones, so it's F♭.
21. S5 · 2m **C: F**. IV = F–A–C. "a" means root position, so the root is in the bass: F.
22. S5 · 2m **C: IV–I**. The first note, C, is in chord IV (F–A–C). The second, C, is in chord I (C–E–G). IV–I makes a plagal cadence.
23. S5 · 2m **C: imperfect**. The last two chords are II (E–G–B) and V (A–C♯–E). Ending on V is imperfect.
24. S5 · 2m **C: G♭ major**. The bottom note is the tonic, G♭. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of G♭ major.
25. S5 · 2m **B: V–I**. The first note, F♯, is in chord V (D–F♯–A). The second, G, is in chord I (G–B–D). V–I makes a perfect cadence.
26. S6 · 1m **C: go straight on to the next section**. attacca is Italian for "go straight on to the next section".
27. S6 · 1m **C: sweet**. douce is French for "sweet".
28. S6 · 1m **B: acciaccatura**. An acciaccatura is a 'crushed' note: tiny, with a slash, played as fast as possible.

29. S6 · 1m **A: woodwind**. The bassoon is in the woodwind family.
30. S6 · 1m **A: upper mordent sign**. The main note, the note above, then back to the main note: an upper mordent.
31. S7 · 2m **A: minor 2nd**. The notes are E♭ and D: a minor 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **B: leading note**. The note marked x is D. Counting up from E♭, that's degree 7, the leading note.
33. S7 · 2m **A: lower mordent**. The sign above the note in bar 5 is a lower mordent.
34. S7 · 2m **D: at a moderate speed**. Modéré means at a moderate speed.
35. S7 · 2m **A: quiet**. p means quiet.

Grade 5 practice paper 3

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)
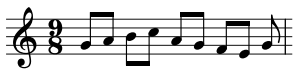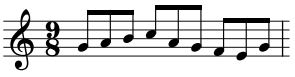
3 marks

1. How can the beats in 7/8 be grouped?

A. 3+3 B. 4+1 C. 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2 D. 2+2+2
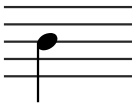
3 marks

2. Which bar is grouped correctly for 9/8?

A.  B. 

3 marks

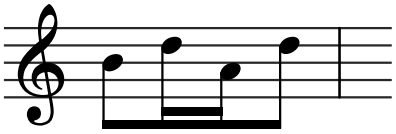
3. How many semiquavers make one crotchet?



A. 6 B. 4 C. 8 D. 5

3 marks
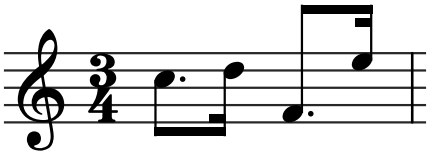
4. Which time signature fits this bar?
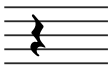
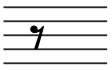
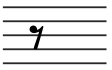


A. 9/8 B. 12/8 C. 3/8 D. 3/4

3 marks

5. Which rest finishes this bar?

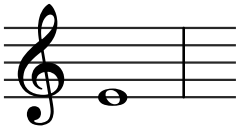


A.  B.  C.  D. 

Section 2: Pitch (15 marks)

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Treble clef)

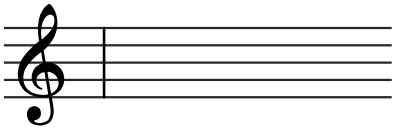


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

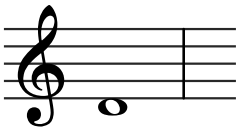
7. Write the tonic (key note) of C major. (Treble clef · any octave)
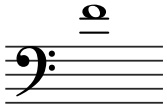
Write your answer on this stave:
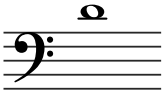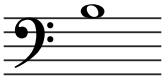


3 marks
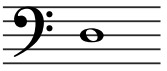
8. Which is the same note, written in bass clef? (Treble clef)



A. 

B. 
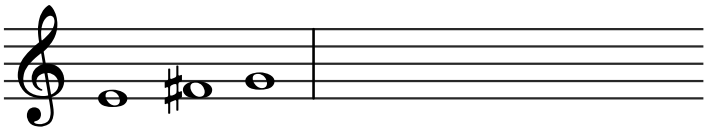
C. 

D. 

3 marks

9. Here is the start of E harmonic minor, going up. Write the next note. (Treble clef · no key signature, so use an accidental if it needs one)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks
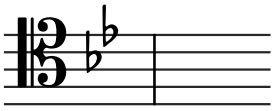
10. Music for trumpet in B♭ is written in E major. Which key does it sound in?

A. C major B. F major C. A major D. D major

Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks
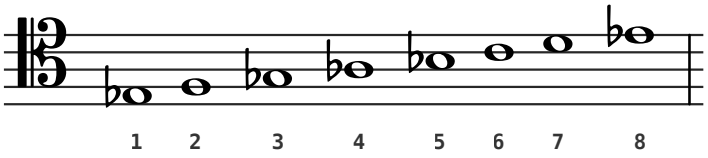
11. Which major key has this key signature? (Tenor clef)



A. E♭ major B. D♭ major C. B♭ major D. A major

2 marks
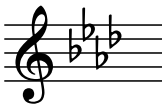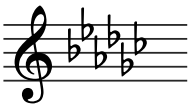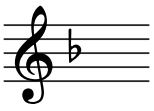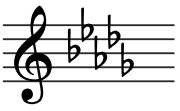
12. One note in this E♭ harmonic minor scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____
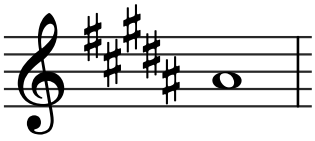
2 marks

13. Which is the key signature of A♭ major?

A.  B.  C.  D. 

2 marks
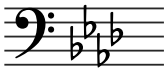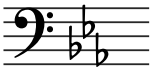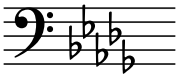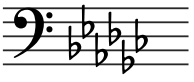
14. In B major, which degree of the scale is this note?



Write your answer: _____

2 marks
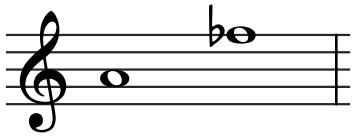
15. Which is the key signature of G♭ major?

A.  B.  C.  D. 

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (A up to F♭)



A. augmented 6th B. major 6th C. diminished 6th D. minor 6th

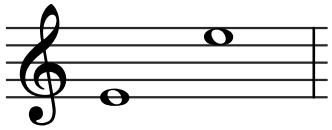
2 marks

17. Which note is a major 3rd above E?

A. A♯ B. G𝄪 C. F♯ D. G♯

2 marks

18. Name this interval. (E up to E)



A. diminished octave B. perfect octave C. major 7th D. major 9th

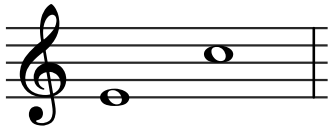
2 marks

19. Which note is a diminished 5th above D?

A. A B. B♭ C. G♭ D. A♭

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (E up to C)
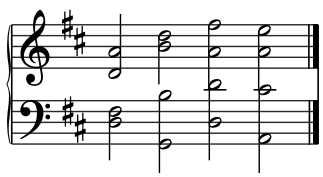


A. diminished 6th B. augmented 6th C. perfect 5th D. minor 6th

Section 5: Chords **(10 marks)**

2 marks

21. This phrase is in D major, for four voices. Which cadence ends it?



A. plagal B. imperfect C. perfect

2 marks

22. What is the relative major?

A minor

A. F major B. F♯ major C. C major D. A major

2 marks

23. Which cadence is this?

V–I

A. imperfect B. perfect C. plagal
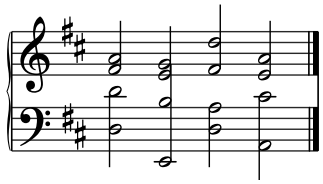
2 marks

24. What is the dominant note of E♭ major?

A. A♭ B. B♭ C. C D. F

2 marks

25. This phrase is in D major, for four voices. Which cadence ends it?



A. plagal B. imperfect C. perfect

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "sweetly"?

Find the term

A. dolce B. moderato C. pianissimo (pp) D. deciso

1 mark

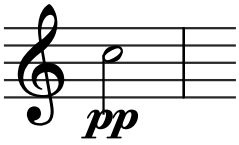
27. What does this mean?

cantabile

A. reinforcing, with a sudden accent B. loud C. moderately quiet D. in a singing style

1 mark

28. What does this sign mean?



A. staccato: short and detached B. pianissimo: very quiet C. diminuendo: gradually getting quieter D. tenuto: hold it for its full length

1 mark
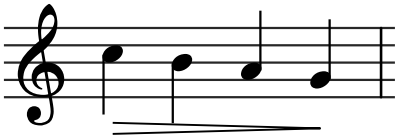
29. Which is the highest male voice?

Voices

A. bass B. tenor C. alto D. soprano

1 mark

30. What does this sign mean?



A. play the note and the note above quickly, many times

B. the place D.S. sends you back to
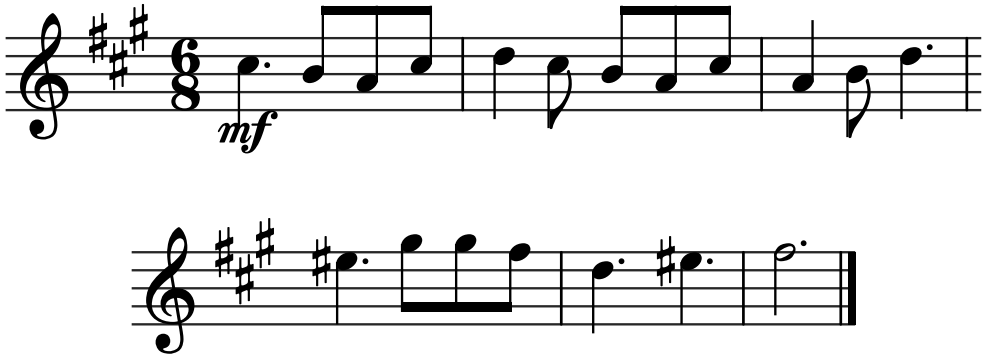
C. the note, the note above, the note again, quickly

D. gradually getting quieter

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)
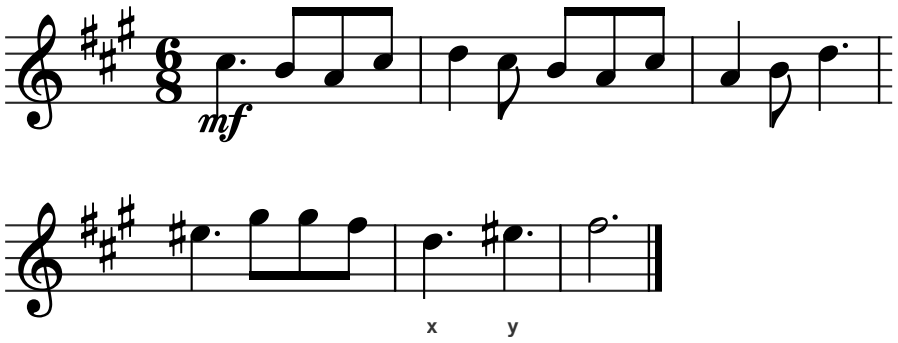
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Lent



2 marks
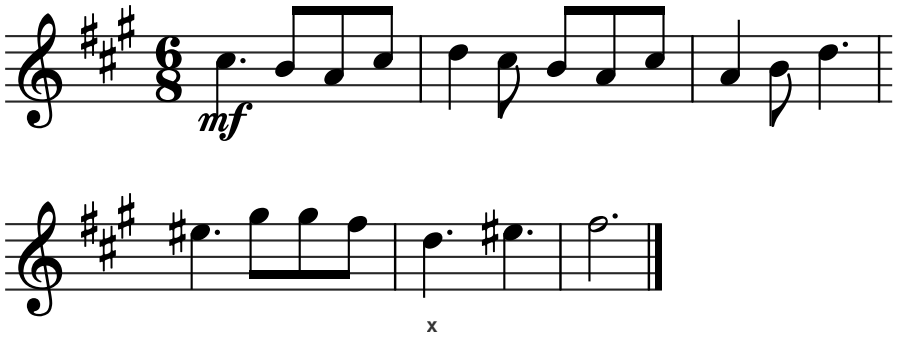
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. augmented 2nd B. major 3rd C. diminished 2nd D. minor 2nd

2 marks
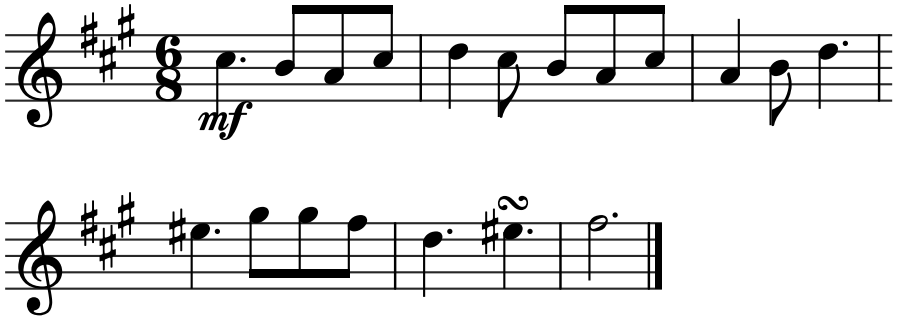
32. The melody is in F♯ minor. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. dominant B. tonic C. submediant D. supertonic

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 5 called?



A. trill B. turn C. acciaccatura D. lower mordent

2 marks

34. What does "Lent" mean?

A. suddenly B. slow C. loud, then immediately quiet D. detached

2 marks

35. What does mf under the first note mean?

A. moderately loud B. quiet C. loud D. very loud

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **C: 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2**. 7/8 is irregular: the 7 quavers are grouped in 2s and 3s: 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2.
2. S1 · 3m **B: grouped correctly**. 9/8 has dotted-crotchet beats, so the quavers go in groups of three. Pairs of quavers make it look like simple time.
3. S1 · 3m **B: 4**. A crotchet lasts 1 crotchet beat. A semiquaver lasts ¼. 1 ÷ ¼ = 4.
4. S1 · 3m **C: 3/8**. The notes add up to 3 quavers, so 3/8 fits.
5. S1 · 3m **A: crotchet rest**. A bar of 3/4 holds 3 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one crotchet, so a crotchet rest finishes it.
6. S2 · 3m **E**. E. It's the landmark E: the bottom line.
7. S2 · 3m **C**. The tonic of C major is C.
8. S2 · 3m **B: bass clef note D4**. It's D, at exactly the same pitch. Watch out for the one an octave away: same letter, wrong place.
9. S2 · 3m **A (treble clef, 5 steps above middle C)**. Note 4 of E harmonic minor is A.
10. S2 · 3m **D: D major**. The trumpet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower than written. A major 2nd below E is D, so it sounds in D major (2 sharps).
11. S3 · 2m **C: B♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is B♭, so B♭ major.
12. S3 · 2m **6**. Note 6 should be C♭, not C. Harmonic minor raises the 7th.
13. S3 · 2m **A: 4 flats**. A♭ major has 4 flats.
14. S3 · 2m **7**. Count up from B: B, C♯, D♯, E, F♯, G♯, A♯. So A♯ is degree 7, the leading note.
15. S3 · 2m **D: 6 flats**. G♭ major has 6 flats.
16. S4 · 2m **C: diminished 6th**. Count the letters A B C D E F: that's a 6th. 7 semitones, so it's a diminished 6th.
17. S4 · 2m **D: G♯**. Count 3 letters up from E to get G. A major 3rd is 4 semitones, so it's G♯.
18. S4 · 2m **B: perfect octave**. Count the letters E F G A B C D E: that's an octave. 12 semitones, so it's a perfect octave.
19. S4 · 2m **D: A♭**. Count 5 letters up from D to get A. A diminished 5th is 6 semitones, so it's A♭.
20. S4 · 2m **D: minor 6th**. Count the letters E F G A B C: that's a 6th. 8 semitones, so it's a minor 6th.
21. S5 · 2m **B: imperfect**. The last two chords are I (D–F♯–A) and V (A–C♯–E). Ending on V is imperfect.
22. S5 · 2m **C: C major**. The relative major starts on note 3 of the minor scale: C major.
23. S5 · 2m **B: perfect**. V–I is a perfect cadence: a strong, finished ending.
24. S5 · 2m **B: B♭**. The dominant is degree 5: B♭.
25. S5 · 2m **B: imperfect**. The last two chords are I (D–F♯–A) and V (A–C♯–E). Ending on V is imperfect.
26. S6 · 1m **A: dolce**. dolce is Italian for "sweetly".
27. S6 · 1m **D: in a singing style**. cantabile is Italian for "in a singing style".
28. S6 · 1m **B: pianissimo: very quiet**. It means pianissimo: very quiet.
29. S6 · 1m **B: tenor**. From high to low: soprano, alto, tenor, bass. Soprano and alto are usually women's and children's voices; tenor and bass are men's.
30. S6 · 1m **D: gradually getting quieter**. That's a diminuendo (hairpin): gradually getting quieter.
31. S7 · 2m **A: augmented 2nd**. The notes are D and E♯: an augmented 2nd.

32. S7 · 2m **C: submediant**. The note marked x is D. Counting up from F♯, that's degree 6, the submediant.
33. S7 · 2m **B: turn**. The sign above the note in bar 5 is a turn.
34. S7 · 2m **B: slow**. Lent means slow.
35. S7 · 2m **A: moderately loud**. mf means moderately loud.

Grade 5 practice paper 4

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
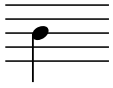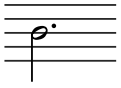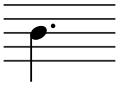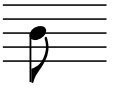
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

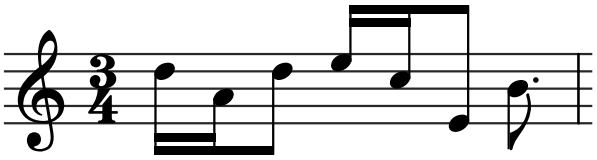
3 marks
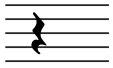
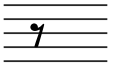
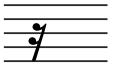
1. Which note lasts as long as a crotchet and a quaver?

A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks

2. Which rest finishes this bar?



A.  B.  C.  D. 

3 marks
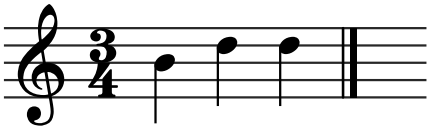
3. A sextuplet of semiquavers (marked 6) takes the time of how many ordinary semiquavers?

Sextuplet

A. 5 B. 2 C. 4 D. 3

3 marks
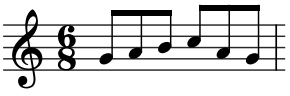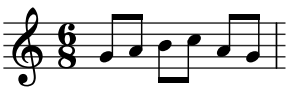
4. This bar is in 3/4. If every note is rewritten at half the value, what is the new time signature?



A. 3/8 B. 3/4 C. 3/2 D. 3/16

3 marks

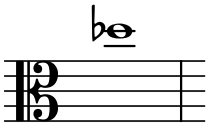
5. Which bar is grouped correctly for 6/8?

A.  B. 

Section 2: Pitch (15 marks)

3 marks
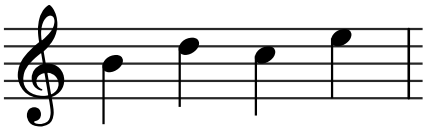
6. Name this note. (Alto clef)



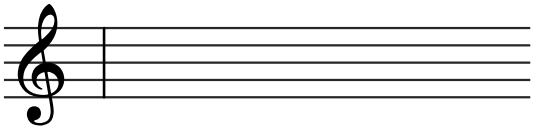
Write your answer: _____

3 marks

7. This tune is written for clarinet in B♭. Write the 4 notes that actually sound (concert pitch). (Treble clef · use accidentals)
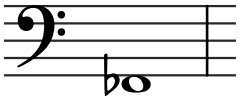


Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks
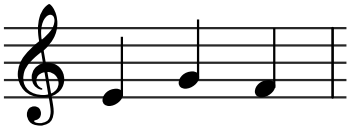
8. Name this note. (Bass clef)



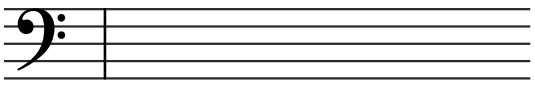
Write your answer: _____

3 marks

9. Write this tune one octave lower in bass clef. (Given in treble clef)
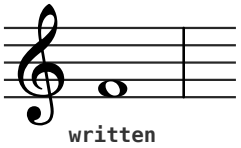


Write your answer on this stave:

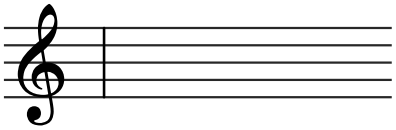


3 marks

10. This is written for clarinet in B♭. Write the note that actually sounds. (Treble clef, concert pitch · use an accidental if it needs one)



Write your answer on this stave:



Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks

11. Which minor key has 2 sharps?

A. G♯ minor B. F♯ minor C. A minor D. B minor

2 marks

12. Which note sounds the same as F♭?

A. E B. G♭ C. E♯ D. F♯
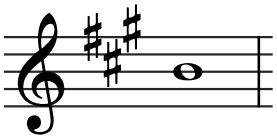
2 marks

13. Which minor key has 1 flat?

A. C♯ minor B. D minor C. E♭ minor D. B minor

2 marks

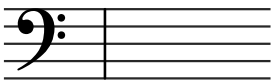
14. In A major, which degree of the scale is this note?



Write your answer: _____

2 marks

15. Which minor key has this key signature? (Bass clef)
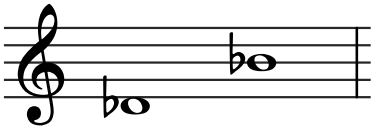


A. D minor B. A minor C. C♯ minor D. F minor

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks
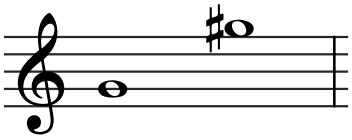
16. Name this interval. (D♭ up to B♭)



A. diminished 6th B. major 6th C. major 7th D. augmented 6th

2 marks

17. Name this interval. (G up to G♯)



A. augmented 7th B. perfect octave C. augmented 9th D. augmented octave

2 marks

18. Which note is a perfect octave above E?

A. F B. E C. E♯ D. E♭

2 marks

19. Which note is a minor 7th above G♭?

A. F B. E♭ C. F♭ D. G♭

2 marks
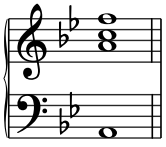
20. Which note is a diminished octave above A?

A. A𝄫 B. A C. A♭ D. B♭

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks
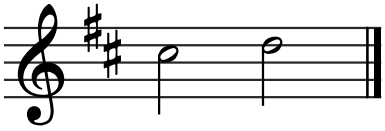
21. Name this chord in B♭ major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. Ib B. IVb C. Vc D. Vb

2 marks

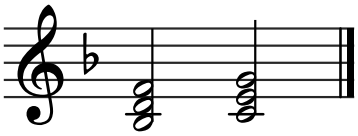
22. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in D major. Which chords make a perfect cadence?



A. IV–I B. II–V C. V–I D. IV–V

2 marks

23. These are the last two chords of a piece in F major. Which cadence is it?



A. imperfect B. plagal C. perfect

2 marks

24. What is the subdominant of A♭ major?

A. A♭ B. E♭ C. C D. D♭

2 marks

25. What is the relative minor?

A♭ major

A. C♯ minor B. D♯ minor C. E minor D. F minor

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. What does this mean?

animé

A. animated, lively B. decisively C. rather slow (less slow than largo) D. very, much

1 mark
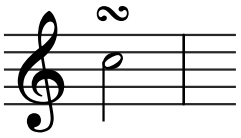
27. Which term means "more"?

Find the term

A. cantabile B. più C. adagio D. fortissimo (ff)

1 mark
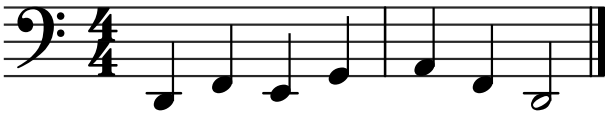
28. What is this ornament called?



A. trill B. upper mordent C. lower mordent D. turn

1 mark
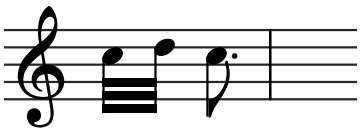
29. Which of these instruments could play this melody?
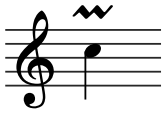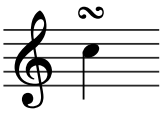


A. flute B. piccolo C. tuba D. violin
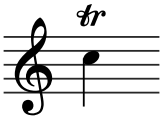
1 mark
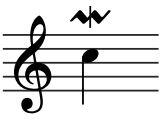
30. These notes are a written-out ornament. Which sign means the same?



A. 

B. 
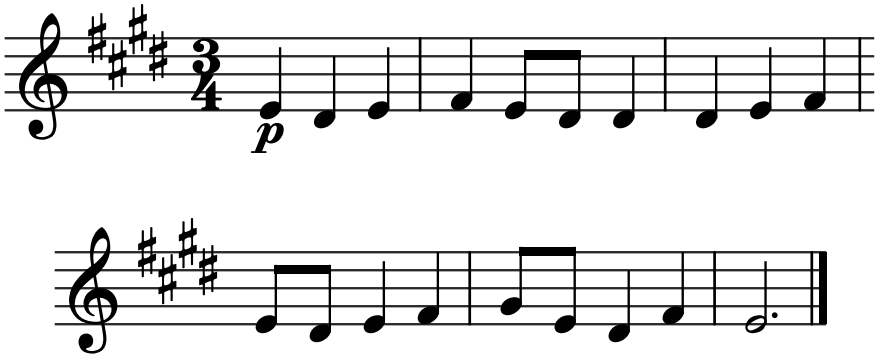
C. 

D. 

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

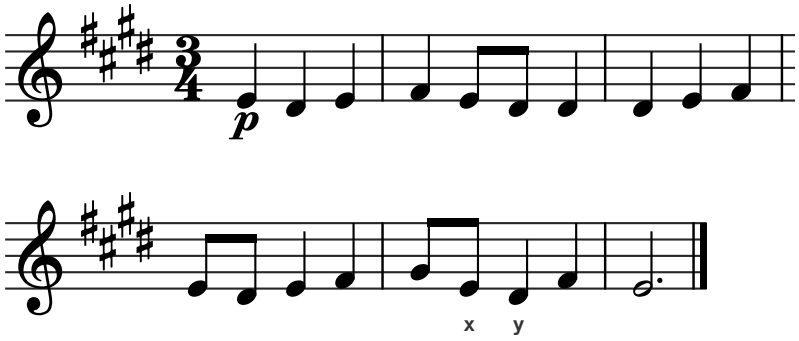
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Ruhig



2 marks

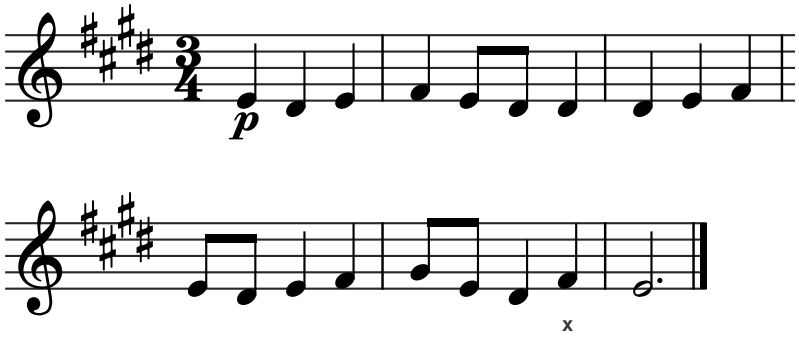
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. diminished 2nd B. minor 2nd C. major 3rd D. major 2nd

2 marks

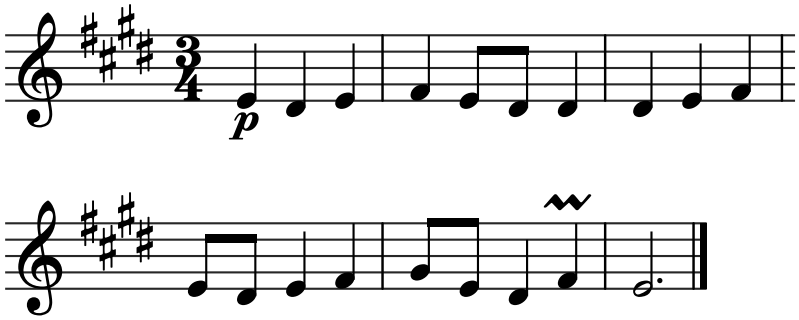
32. The melody is in E major. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. subdominant B. mediant C. supertonic D. submediant

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 5 called?



A. acciaccatura B. trill C. upper mordent D. turn

2 marks

34. What does "Ruhig" mean?

A. at the first speed B. repeat from the beginning C. gracefully D. peaceful

2 marks

35. What does p under the first note mean?

A. very loud B. quiet C. moderately loud D. moderately quiet

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **C: dotted crotchet**. A crotchet and a quaver last 1.5 beats, the same as a dotted crotchet.
2. S1 · 3m **D: semiquaver rest**. A bar of 3/4 holds 3 crotchet beats. The notes leave a gap of one semiquaver, so a semiquaver rest finishes it.
3. S1 · 3m **C: 4**. Six semiquavers in a sextuplet take the time of four.
4. S1 · 3m **A: 3/8**. The top number (how many beats) stays 3. Each crotchet becomes a quaver, so the bottom number changes from 4 to 8: 3/8.
5. S1 · 3m **A: grouped correctly**. 6/8 has dotted-crotchet beats, so the quavers go in groups of three. Pairs of quavers make it look like 3/4.
6. S2 · 3m **D♭**. D♭. Landmark: B, one ledger line above. This note is 2 steps above it: B, C, D. The flat makes it D♭.
7. S2 · 3m **A, C, B♭, D (treble clef)**. The clarinet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower: B, D, C, E sounds as A, C, B♭, D.
8. S2 · 3m **F♭**. F♭. Landmark: G, the bottom line. This note is 1 step below it: G, F. The flat makes it F♭.
9. S2 · 3m **E, G, F (bass clef)**. The notes are E, G, F, each moved down an octave.
10. S2 · 3m **E♭ (treble clef, 2 steps above middle C)**. The clarinet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower than written: F sounds as E♭.
11. S3 · 2m **D: B minor**. 2 sharps: F♯ C♯. The last sharp is C♯; one step up is D major, and its relative minor is B minor.
12. S3 · 2m **A: E**. F♭ and E are enharmonic equivalents: the same key on the piano, written with a different letter name.
13. S3 · 2m **B: D minor**. 1 flat: B♭. One flat is F major major, and its relative minor is D minor.
14. S3 · 2m **2**. Count up from A: A, B. So B is degree 2, the supertonic.
15. S3 · 2m **B: A minor**. No sharps or flats. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is A minor.
16. S4 · 2m **B: major 6th**. Count the letters D E F G A B: that's a 6th. 9 semitones, so it's a major 6th.
17. S4 · 2m **D: augmented octave**. Count the letters G A B C D E F G: that's an octave. 13 semitones, so it's an augmented octave.
18. S4 · 2m **B: E**. Count 8 letters up from E to get E. A perfect octave is 12 semitones, so it's E.
19. S4 · 2m **C: F♭**. Count 7 letters up from G♭ to get F. A minor 7th is 10 semitones, so it's F♭.
20. S4 · 2m **C: A♭**. Count 8 letters up from A to get A. A diminished octave is 11 semitones, so it's A♭.
21. S5 · 2m **D: Vb**. Put the notes in 3rds: F–A–C. The root is F, degree 5, so it's chord V. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is A: the 3rd, so b.
22. S5 · 2m **C: V–I**. The first note, C♯, is in chord V (A–C♯–E). The second, D, is in chord I (D–F♯–A). V–I makes a perfect cadence.
23. S5 · 2m **A: imperfect**. The chords are IV (B♭–D–F) then V (C–E–G). Ending on V is imperfect.
24. S5 · 2m **D: D♭**. The subdominant is degree 4. In A♭ major that's D♭.
25. S5 · 2m **D: F minor**. Count up to note 6 of A♭ major: F. Both keys share the same key signature.
26. S6 · 1m **A: animated, lively**. animé is French for "animated, lively".
27. S6 · 1m **B: più**. più is Italian for "more".
28. S6 · 1m **D: turn**. That sign is a turn.

29. S6 · 1m **C: tuba**. These notes are well below middle C. The flute, violin, oboe and trumpet can't play that low. The tuba can.
30. S6 · 1m **A: upper mordent sign**. The main note, the note above, then back to the main note: an upper mordent.
31. S7 · 2m **B: minor 2nd**. The notes are E and D♯: a minor 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **C: supertonic**. The note marked x is F♯. Counting up from E, that's degree 2, the supertonic.
33. S7 · 2m **C: upper mordent**. The sign above the note in bar 5 is an upper mordent.
34. S7 · 2m **D: peaceful**. Ruhig means peaceful.
35. S7 · 2m **B: quiet**. p means quiet.

Grade 5 practice paper 5

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65
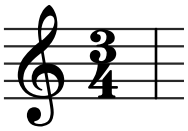
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks
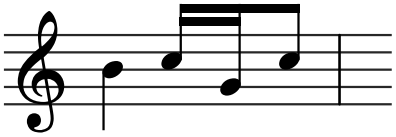
1. How many beats in a bar, and what is the beat?



A. 3 dotted quavers B. 3 quavers C. 3 minims D. 3 crotchets

3 marks
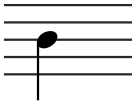
2. Which time signature fits this bar?



A. 3/8 B. 2/4 C. 3/4 D. 9/8

3 marks

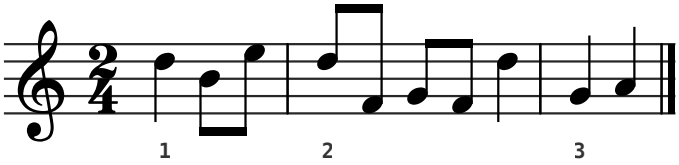
3. How many demisemiquavers make one crotchet?



A. 16 B. 8 C. 7 D. 4

3 marks
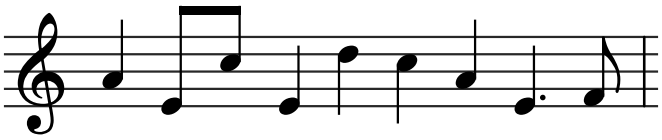
4. One bar has the wrong number of beats for 2/4. Which bar?



A. Bar 1 B. Bar 2 C. Bar 3

3 marks

5. Which time signature fits this bar?

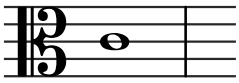


A. 2/4 B. 2/2 C. 3/4 D. 4/2

Section 2: Pitch (15 marks)

3 marks
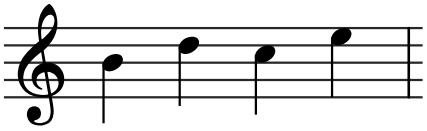
6. Is this note above, below or at middle C? (Alto clef)



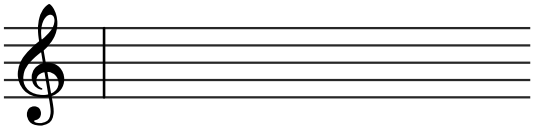
A. Above middle C B. Below middle C C. It is middle C

3 marks

7. This tune is written for clarinet in B♭. Write the 4 notes that actually sound (concert pitch). (Treble clef · use accidentals)

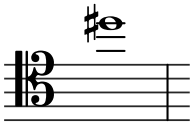


Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks

8. Name this note. (Tenor clef)
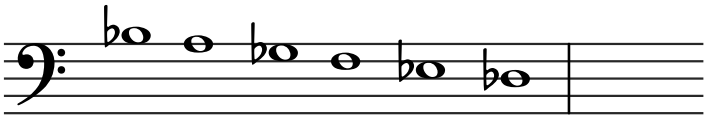


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

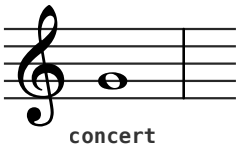
9. Here is the start of B♭ harmonic minor, going down. Write the next note. (Bass clef · no key signature, so use an accidental if it needs one)

Write your answer on this stave:

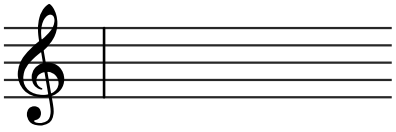


3 marks

10. This note is at concert pitch. Write it for clarinet in A. (Treble clef · use an accidental if it needs one)
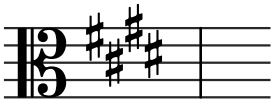


Write your answer on this stave:



Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)

2 marks
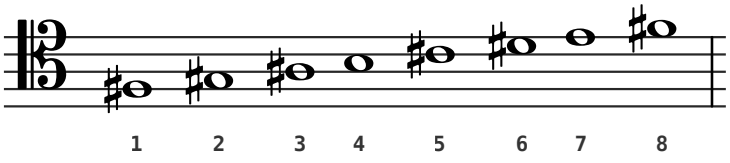
11. Which minor key has this key signature? (Alto clef)



A. F♯ minor B. C♯ minor C. D♯ minor D. F minor

2 marks

12. One note in this F♯ major scale is wrong. Which number is it?



Write your answer: _____
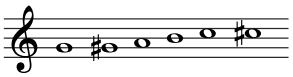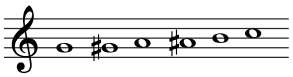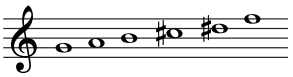
2 marks

13. Which pair of keys has 6 flats?

A. G♭ major and D minor B. G♭ major and E♭ minor C. G♭ major and G♭ minor D. E♭ major and G♭ minor

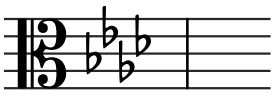
2 marks

14. Which of these is part of a chromatic scale?

A.  B.  C. 

2 marks

15. Which major key has this key signature? (Alto clef)

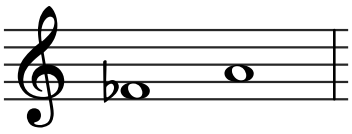


A. D♭ major B. A major C. A♭ major D. F♯ major

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

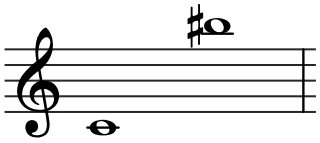
16. Name this interval. (F♭ up to A)



A. major 3rd B. augmented 3rd C. minor 3rd D. augmented 4th

2 marks

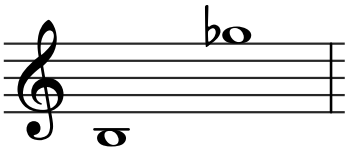
17. Name this interval. (C up to B♯)



A. major 14th B. minor 14th C. augmented 13th D. augmented 14th

2 marks

18. Name this interval. (B up to G♭)



A. diminished 13th B. major 13th C. minor 13th D. diminished 12th
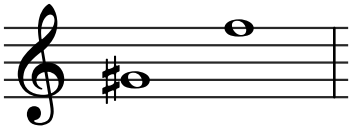
2 marks

19. Which note is a diminished 4th above F♯?

A. B B. B♭ C. C♭ D. A♭

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (G♯ up to F)
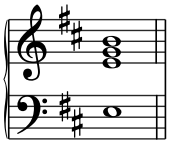


A. diminished 7th B. diminished octave C. augmented 7th D. major 7th

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks
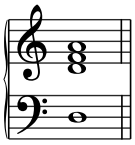
21. Name this chord in D major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. IIb B. IVc C. Ic D. IIa

2 marks

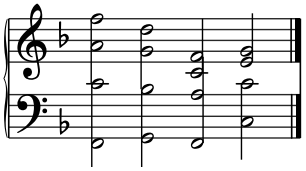
22. Name this chord in C major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. Ib B. IVb C. IVc D. IIa

2 marks
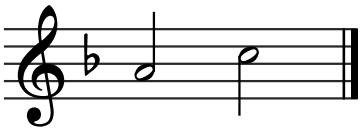
23. This phrase is in F major, for four voices. Which cadence ends it?



A. perfect B. plagal C. imperfect

2 marks
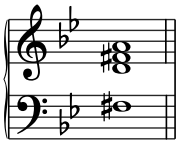
24. These are the last two melody notes of a phrase in F major. Which chords make an imperfect cadence?



A. I–V B. V–I C. II–V D. IV–V

2 marks

25. Name this chord in G minor. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. IIb B. Vb C. IVb D. Ib

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "with vigour, lively"?

Find the term

A. dolce B. sforzato (sfz) C. meno D. con brio

1 mark
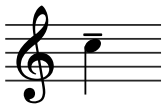
27. Which term means "quiet"?
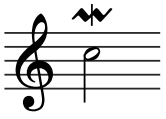
Find the term
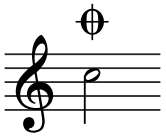
A. una corda B. scherzando C. grazioso D. piano (p)
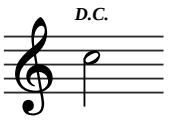
1 mark

28. Which picture shows a tenuto?

A. 

B. 

C. 

D. 

1 mark
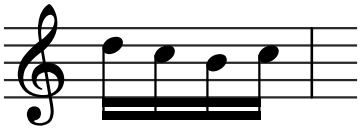
29. Which of these is NOT a string instrument?
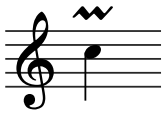
Instruments
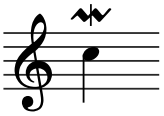
A. harp B. cello C. viola D. oboe
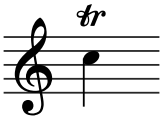
1 mark
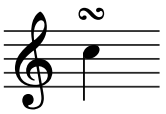
30. These notes are a written-out ornament. Which sign means the same?



A. 

B. 

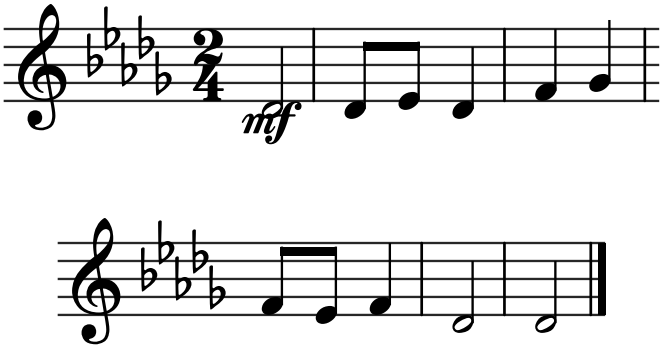
C. 

D. 

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

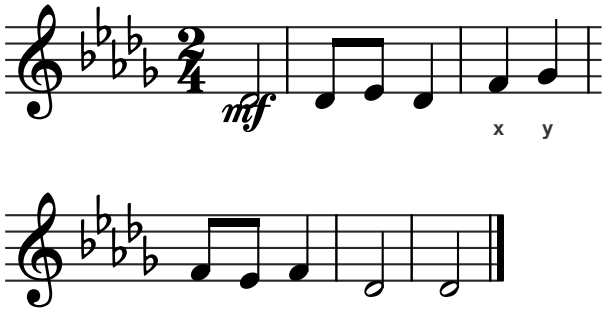
Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

Andante



2 marks
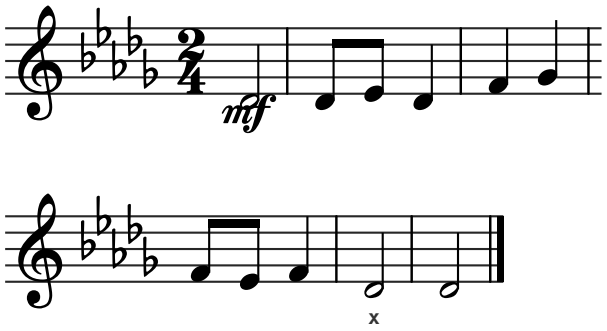
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. minor 2nd B. major 3rd C. major 2nd D. diminished 2nd

2 marks

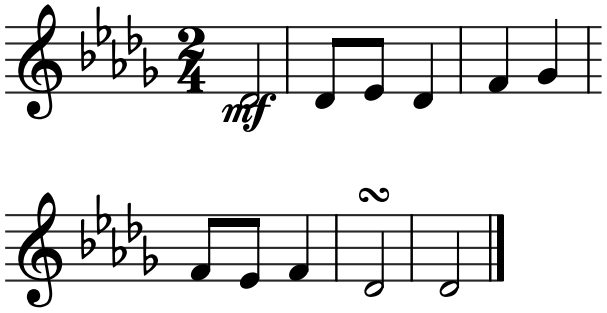
32. The melody is in D♭ major. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. tonic B. leading note C. mediant D. dominant

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 5 called?



A. turn B. upper mordent C. acciaccatura D. lower mordent

2 marks

34. What does "Andante" mean?

A. slow B. suddenly C. with D. at a walking pace

2 marks

35. What does mf under the first note mean?

A. quiet B. very loud C. moderately loud D. loud

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **D: 3 crotchets**. 3/4 is simple: the 4 means a crotchet beat, and there are 3 of them.
2. S1 · 3m **B: 2/4**. The notes add up to 2 crotchet beats, so 2/4 fits.
3. S1 · 3m **B: 8**. A crotchet lasts 1 crotchet beat. A demisemiquaver lasts ⅛. 1 ÷ ⅛ = 8.
4. S1 · 3m **B: Bar 2**. Each bar of 2/4 should hold 2 crotchet beats. Bar 2 has one beat too many.
5. S1 · 3m **D: 4/2**. The notes add up to 4 minim beats, so 4/2 fits.
6. S2 · 3m **C: It is middle C**. In the alto clef, middle C is on the middle line. This note is C, exactly middle C.
7. S2 · 3m **A, C, B♭, D (treble clef)**. The clarinet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower: B, D, C, E sounds as A, C, B♭, D.
8. S2 · 3m **D♯**. D♯. Landmark: G, one ledger line above. This note is 4 steps above it: G, A, B, C, D. The sharp makes it D♯.
9. S2 · 3m **C (bass clef, 7 steps below middle C)**. Note 2 of B♭ harmonic minor is C.
10. S2 · 3m **B♭ (treble clef, 6 steps above middle C)**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than it reads, so write it a minor 3rd higher: G goes up to B♭.
11. S3 · 2m **B: C♯ minor**. The last sharp is D♯. One step up from it is E, so E major. Its relative minor, on degree 6, is C♯ minor.
12. S3 · 2m **7**. Note 7 should be E♯, not E. Major scales go tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone.
13. S3 · 2m **B: G♭ major and E♭ minor**. A major key and its relative minor share a key signature. The relative minor starts on degree 6 of the major scale (3 semitones below the tonic): G♭ major → E♭ minor.
14. S3 · 2m **B: only semitones**. A chromatic scale moves only in semitones, so every note is the very next key on the piano.
15. S3 · 2m **C: A♭ major**. The second-to-last flat is A♭, so A♭ major.
16. S4 · 2m **B: augmented 3rd**. Count the letters F G A: that's a 3rd. 5 semitones, so it's an augmented 3rd.
17. S4 · 2m **D: augmented 14th**. Count the letters C D E F G A B C …: that's a 14th. 24 semitones, so it's an augmented 14th. It's an octave plus a 7th, so it's also a compound augmented 7th.
18. S4 · 2m **A: diminished 13th**. Count the letters B C D E F G A B …: that's a 13th. 19 semitones, so it's a diminished 13th. It's an octave plus a 6th, so it's also a compound diminished 6th.
19. S4 · 2m **B: B♭**. Count 4 letters up from F♯ to get B. A diminished 4th is 4 semitones, so it's B♭.
20. S4 · 2m **A: diminished 7th**. Count the letters G A B C D E F: that's a 7th. 9 semitones, so it's a diminished 7th.
21. S5 · 2m **D: IIa**. Put the notes in 3rds: E–G–B. The root is E, degree 2, so it's chord II. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is E: the root, so a.
22. S5 · 2m **D: IIa**. Put the notes in 3rds: D–F–A. The root is D, degree 2, so it's chord II. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is D: the root, so a.
23. S5 · 2m **C: imperfect**. The last two chords are I (F–A–C) and V (C–E–G). Ending on V is imperfect.
24. S5 · 2m **A: I–V**. The first note, A, is in chord I (F–A–C). The second, C, is in chord V (C–E–G). I–V makes an imperfect cadence.
25. S5 · 2m **B: Vb**. Put the notes in 3rds: D–F♯–A. The root is D, degree 5, so it's chord V. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is F♯: the 3rd, so b.
26. S6 · 1m **D: con brio**. con brio is Italian for "with vigour, lively".
27. S6 · 1m **D: piano (p)**. piano (p) is Italian for "quiet".

28. S6 · 1m **A: tenuto**. Tenuto means hold the note for its full length.
29. S6 · 1m **D: oboe**. The oboe is woodwind. It has a double reed.
30. S6 · 1m **D: turn sign**. The note above, the main note, the note below, then the main note: a turn.
31. S7 · 2m **A: minor 2nd**. The notes are F and G♭: a minor 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **A: tonic**. The note marked x is D♭. Counting up from D♭, that's degree 1, the tonic.
33. S7 · 2m **A: turn**. The sign above the note in bar 5 is a turn.
34. S7 · 2m **D: at a walking pace**. Andante means at a walking pace.
35. S7 · 2m **C: moderately loud**. mf means moderately loud.

Grade 5 practice paper 6

Time allowed: 2 hours · 75 marks · pass 50, merit 60, distinction 65

Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 75

Our own paper in the style of the online exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Read each one twice, skip any you're stuck on and come back, and check at the end.

Section 1: Rhythm (15 marks)

3 marks
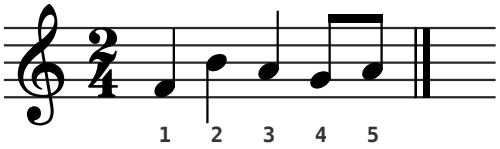
1. A septuplet of semiquavers (marked 7) takes the time of how many ordinary semiquavers?

Septuplet

A. 5 B. 2 C. 3 D. 4

3 marks

2. The first bar line is missing. Where does it go?



A. After note 3 B. After note 1 C. After note 4 D. After note 2

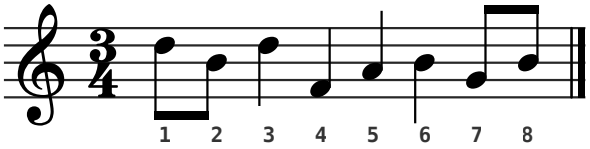
3 marks

3. How can the beats in 7/8 be grouped?

A. 4+1 B. 2+2+2 C. 2+3 or 3+2 D. 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2

3 marks
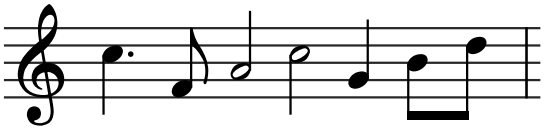
4. The first bar line is missing. Where does it go?



A. After note 4 B. After note 5 C. After note 6 D. After note 3

3 marks

5. Which time signature fits this bar?

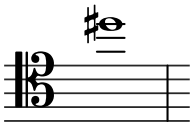


A. 3/8 B. 2/4 C. 4/2 D. 3/2

Section 2: Pitch (15 marks)

3 marks

6. Name this note. (Tenor clef)

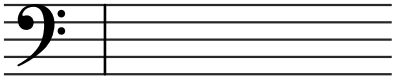


Write your answer: _____

3 marks

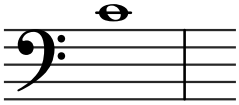
7. Write the tonic (key note) of C major. (Bass clef · any octave)

Write your answer on this stave:



3 marks
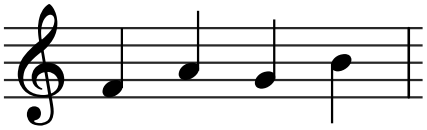
8. Is this note above, below or at middle C? (Bass clef)



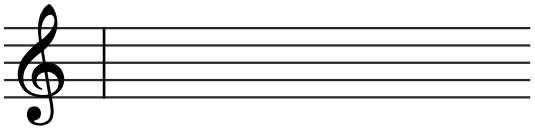
A. Above middle C B. Below middle C C. It is middle C

3 marks

9. This tune is written for clarinet in B♭. Write the 4 notes that actually sound (concert pitch). (Treble clef · use accidentals)

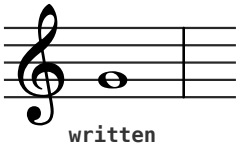


Write your answer on this stave:

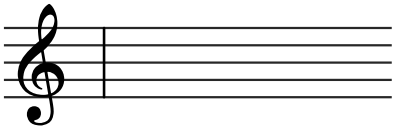


3 marks

10. This is written for trumpet in B♭. Write the note that actually sounds. (Treble clef, concert pitch · use an accidental if it needs one)



Write your answer on this stave:



Section 3: Keys and scales (10 marks)
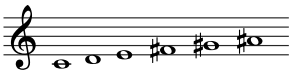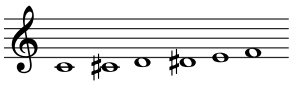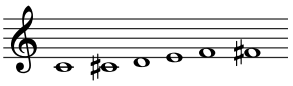
2 marks

11. In a key signature, which is the 4th sharp?

A. F♯ B. D♯ C. A♯ D. B♯

2 marks

12. Which of these is part of a chromatic scale?

A.  B.  C. 

2 marks

13. In a key signature, which is the 4th flat?

A. E♭ B. F♭ C. C♭ D. D♭

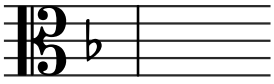
2 marks

14. Which note sounds the same as D♯?

A. E♭ B. E𝄫 C. C♯ D. E

2 marks

15. Which major key has this key signature? (Alto clef)
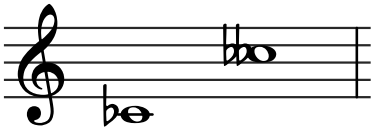


A. A major B. F♯ major C. F major D. E major

Section 4: Intervals (10 marks)

2 marks

16. Name this interval. (C♭ up to C𝄫)



A. diminished 9th B. diminished 7th C. diminished octave D. augmented octave
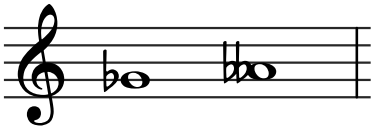
2 marks

17. Which note is a diminished 2nd above F♯?

A. G B. G𝄫 C. G♭ D. A♭

2 marks

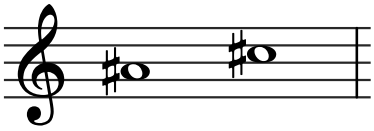
18. Name this interval. (G♭ up to A𝄫)



A. minor 3rd B. augmented 2nd C. major 2nd D. minor 2nd

2 marks

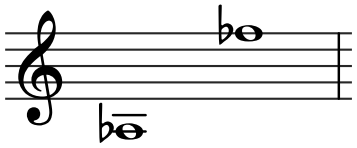
19. Name this interval. (A♯ up to C♯)



A. augmented 3rd B. major 3rd C. minor 3rd D. diminished 3rd

2 marks

20. Name this interval. (A♭ up to F♭)

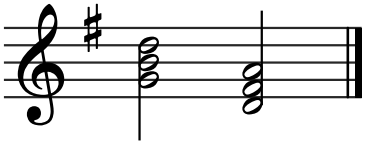


A. diminished 13th B. minor 13th C. augmented 13th D. minor 14th

Section 5: Chords (10 marks)

2 marks
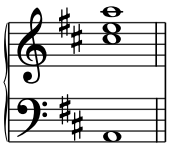
21. These are the last two chords of a piece in G major. Which cadence is it?



A. imperfect B. plagal C. perfect

2 marks

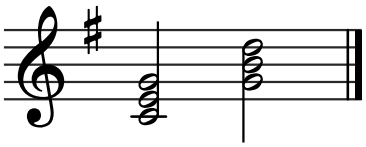
22. Name this chord in D major. Use the numeral and a, b or c.



A. Va B. IVa C. Ia D. IIa

2 marks

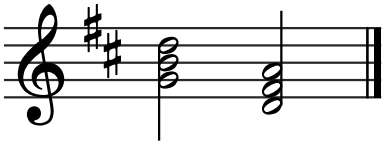
23. These are the last two chords of a piece in G major. Which cadence is it?



A. perfect B. imperfect C. plagal

2 marks

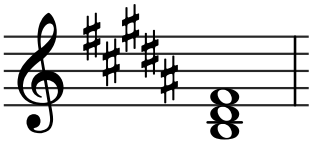
24. These are the last two chords of a piece in D major. Which cadence is it?



A. imperfect B. plagal C. perfect

2 marks

25. This is a tonic triad. Which key is it in?



A. G major B. F major C. B major D. E♭ major

Section 6: Terms, signs and instruments (5 marks)

1 mark

26. Which term means "moderately quiet"?

Find the term

A. troppo B. sempre C. delicato D. mezzo piano (mp)

1 mark
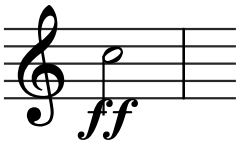
27. Which term means "with vigour, lively"?

Find the term

A. larghetto B. molto C. con brio D. legato

1 mark

28. What does this sign mean?



A. fortissimo: very loud B. diminuendo: gradually getting quieter C. pause: hold the note longer D. pianissimo: very quiet

1 mark

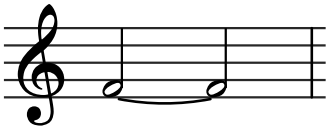
29. Which family makes sound with buzzing lips?

Instruments

A. strings B. brass C. percussion D. woodwind

1 mark

30. Is this curved line a tie or a slur?
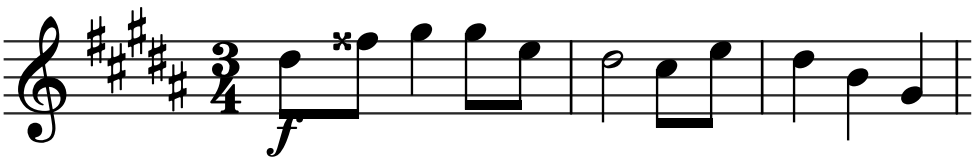


A. Slur B. Tie

Section 7: Music in context (10 marks)

Look at this melody, then answer the questions.

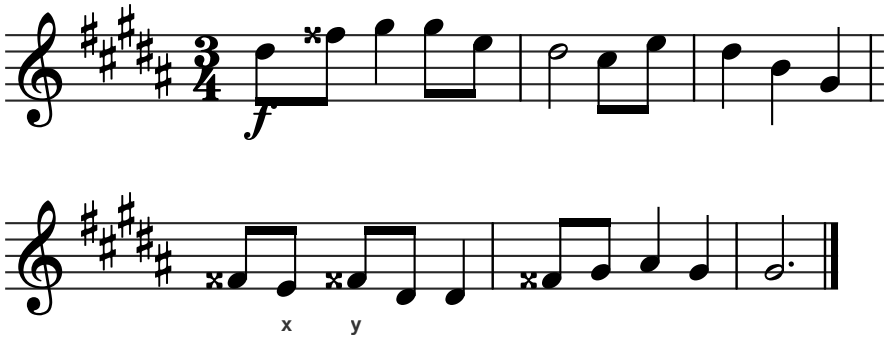
Mässig





2 marks

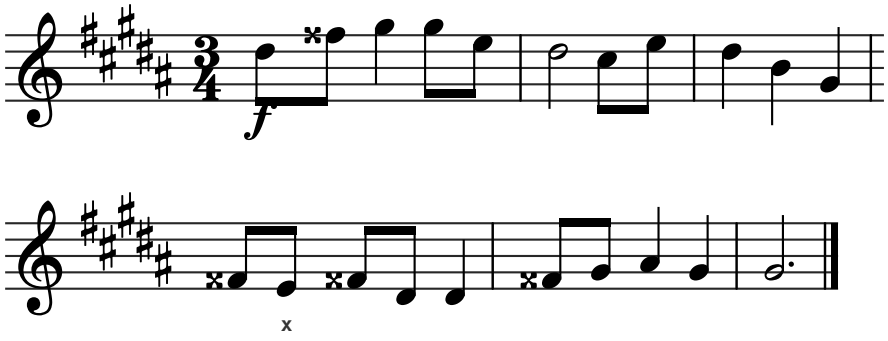
31. Name the interval between the notes marked x and y.



A. diminished 2nd B. major 3rd C. augmented 2nd D. minor 2nd

2 marks

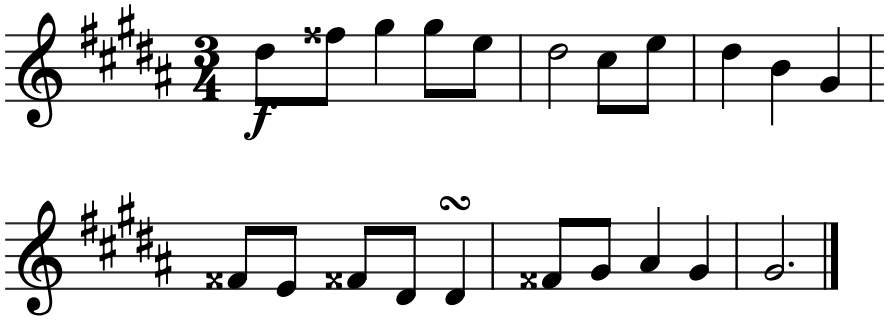
32. The melody is in G♯ minor. What is the technical name of the note marked x?



A. submediant B. leading note C. subdominant D. supertonic

2 marks

33. What is the ornament in bar 4 called?



A. lower mordent B. trill C. upper mordent D. turn

2 marks

34. What does "Mässig" mean?

A. detached B. as fast as possible C. loud D. at a moderate speed

2 marks

35. What does f under the first note mean?

A. moderately loud B. quiet C. loud D. very quiet

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. S1 · 3m **D: 4**. Seven semiquavers in a septuplet take the time of four.
2. S1 · 3m **D: After note 2**. A bar of 2/4 holds 2 crotchet beats. Notes 1 to 2 fill it exactly, so the bar line goes after note 2.
3. S1 · 3m **D: 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2**. 7/8 is irregular: the 7 quavers are grouped in 2s and 3s: 2+2+3, 2+3+2 or 3+2+2.
4. S1 · 3m **A: After note 4**. A bar of 3/4 holds 3 crotchet beats. Notes 1 to 4 fill it exactly, so the bar line goes after note 4.
5. S1 · 3m **C: 4/2**. The notes add up to 4 minim beats, so 4/2 fits.
6. S2 · 3m **D♯**. D♯. Landmark: G, one ledger line above. This note is 4 steps above it: G, A, B, C, D. The sharp makes it D♯.
7. S2 · 3m **C**. The tonic of C major is C.
8. S2 · 3m **C: It is middle C**. In the bass clef, middle C is on the first ledger line above the stave. This note is C, exactly middle C.
9. S2 · 3m **E♭, G, F, A (treble clef)**. The clarinet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower: F, A, G, B sounds as E♭, G, F, A.
10. S2 · 3m **F (treble clef, 3 steps above middle C)**. The trumpet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower than written: G sounds as F.
11. S3 · 2m **B: D♯**. Sharps always go in the same order: F♯ C♯ G♯ D♯ A♯ E♯ B♯. The 4th is D♯.
12. S3 · 2m **B: only semitones**. A chromatic scale moves only in semitones, so every note is the very next key on the piano.
13. S3 · 2m **D: D♭**. Flats always go in the same order: B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭ G♭ C♭ F♭. The 4th is D♭.
14. S3 · 2m **A: E♭**. D♯ and E♭ are enharmonic equivalents: the same key on the piano, written with a different letter name.
15. S3 · 2m **C: F major**. One flat (B♭) means F major.
16. S4 · 2m **C: diminished octave**. Count the letters C D E F G A B C: that's an octave. 11 semitones, so it's a diminished octave.
17. S4 · 2m **C: G♭**. Count 2 letters up from F♯ to get G. A diminished 2nd is 0 semitones, so it's G♭.
18. S4 · 2m **D: minor 2nd**. Count the letters G A: that's a 2nd. 1 semitones, so it's a minor 2nd.
19. S4 · 2m **C: minor 3rd**. Count the letters A B C: that's a 3rd. 3 semitones, so it's a minor 3rd.
20. S4 · 2m **B: minor 13th**. Count the letters A B C D E F G A …: that's a 13th. 20 semitones, so it's a minor 13th. It's an octave plus a 6th, so it's also a compound minor 6th.
21. S5 · 2m **A: imperfect**. The chords are I (G–B–D) then V (D–F♯–A). Ending on V is imperfect.
22. S5 · 2m **A: Va**. Put the notes in 3rds: A–C♯–E. The root is A, degree 5, so it's chord V. The lowest note, in the bass stave, is A: the root, so a.
23. S5 · 2m **C: plagal**. The chords are IV (C–E–G) then I (G–B–D). IV–I is plagal.
24. S5 · 2m **B: plagal**. The chords are IV (G–B–D) then I (D–F♯–A). IV–I is plagal.
25. S5 · 2m **C: B major**. The bottom note is the tonic, B. With this key signature, that makes it the tonic triad of B major.
26. S6 · 1m **D: mezzo piano (mp)**. mezzo piano (mp) is Italian for "moderately quiet".
27. S6 · 1m **C: con brio**. con brio is Italian for "with vigour, lively".

28. S6 · 1m **A: fortissimo: very loud**. It means fortissimo: very loud.
29. S6 · 1m **B: brass**. Brass players buzz their lips into a mouthpiece.
30. S6 · 1m **B: Tie**. It joins two notes of the same pitch, so it's a tie: play one long note.
31. S7 · 2m **C: augmented 2nd**. The notes are E and F𝄪: an augmented 2nd.
32. S7 · 2m **A: submediant**. The note marked x is E. Counting up from G♯, that's degree 6, the submediant.
33. S7 · 2m **D: turn**. The sign above the note in bar 4 is a turn.
34. S7 · 2m **D: at a moderate speed**. Mässig means at a moderate speed.
35. S7 · 2m **C: loud**. f means loud.